⚡Odin Reviewer Handbook

LAST UPDATED: Oct 28, 2026

Confidentiality

All Odin project information and materials are confidential. This includes the project name, client identity, nature of the work and your involvement, along with this handbook, task materials, recordings, screenshots and review feedback.

Use project materials only for authorized project work. Share them only through approved project channels with people authorized to access them. Do not post, publish, sell or share them externally, including in videos, on social media or websites, or in external group chats.

Do not confirm or deny guesses about the project or client, even if someone appears to know the details already.

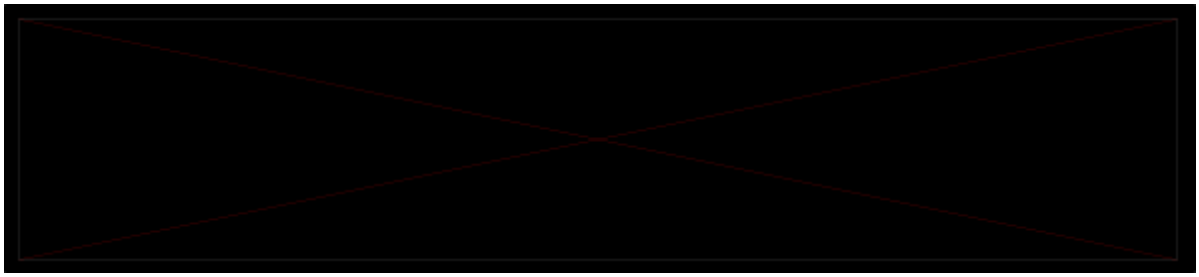
How the Odin Reviewer Handbook is structured

Use the tabs below to find each part of the workflow.

Section	Goal
01. Start Here	This page introduces the project and role.
02. Changelog	Updates to this guidance. Check regularly!
03. Onboarding	Details on the steps to get onboarded as a reviewer
04. Reviewer Expectations	General expectations, pay, and role tiers
05. Workflow	Workflow for how to conduct reviews
06. Reviewer Checklist	Detailed guidance for how to score each dimension in the review, and a quick reference decision making table
07. FAQ	Frequently Asked Questions

08. Examples	Examples of good vs bad tasks
09. Feedback Templates	Some templates you can use when providing feedback

What is Odin?



Your Role

The review process is a **partnership** with the top goal being the quality of the task. Our goal as a team is to produce the highest quality tasks with the highest efficiency. These guidelines outline the review process with the mindset that this is a **collaboration between peers**.

Writers and reviewers are partners in the process. The writers work on creating a high quality task based on their expert knowledge in their corresponding field. The reviewers work alongside the writers as a second set of expert eyes to help validate and refine the task.

The reviewer's mission is to:

✅ **Validate** the accuracy and adherence to all project guidelines.

✅ **Elevate** the quality of the task by identifying areas for improvement.

✅ **Facilitate** a smooth and efficient workflow through clear, structured communication.

✅ **Demonstrate** a professional, respectful tone that keeps feedback collaborative and solutions-focused.

There are specific onboarding steps in Section 3, but please review this whole guide before you begin reviewing.

You can also read the Writer Handbook for more details on how tasks are written.

🖊️ Changelog of Reviewer Guidelines

This list is updated whenever something in this guide changes.
Please review it regularly to ensure you implement recent changes!

Date	Details of changes
Oct 30, 2026	🟩 Clarified that reviewers and auditors assess and correct the final file in Metadata.rtf Upload.
Oct 29, 2026	🟩 Quick review now has 6 dimensions: added licensing (no Canva library or stock-site assets, stock MIDI or video, copied website text or unsourced assets). Applies to quick reviews from Oct 29, 2026. Issues QC finds outside the quick review dimensions are not counted against the quick reviewer. Full review item 4 now fails when deliverables.zip is missing an input file used in the task or the final output. 🟩Review limit is now 3 per task - writers have until October 30th, 11:59 PM PT to submit their final revision if they are already past their third review
Oct 28, 2026	🟩 New format for Reviewer Handbook. Consolidated all reviewer documents into this single source of truth.
Oct 27, 2026	🟩 October 27 quality alignment: intro length, silence duration and click pacing removed from reviewer scoring. Intro and silence remain in AutoQC but never block approval. Minor non-English content on screen is acceptable; narration must be fully in English. 🟩 Reviewers can write tasks when review queue is clear. Do not track time while writing. Pay is a flat rate $100 + $2/minute for each RFD task.
Oct 26, 2026	🟩 Poor window management can cause sendback; same-app dialogue box is still an exception 🟩 Bottom dock alone should not trigger a send-back as long as at least one UI element has been changed
Oct 25, 2026	🟩 New 3 band checklist (1=ideal, 2=tolerable, 3=fail). Send back with anything marked 3. 🟩 Historical intro timing guidance, superseded October 27: intro length is now advisory only and never blocks approval. 🟩 Missing epilogue not a sendback reason 🟩 If Metadata.rtf has an issue, fix rather than sendback 🟩 Updated Quick review eligibility, checklist, timing 🟩 Maximum of 4 reviews per task

Date	Details of changes
	🟩 Claim timing: finish reviews within about an hour; use Extend Review Claim if needed. Tasks held over 2 hours may be released. 🟩 Onboarding pay and hour limits for reviewers follow your individual invitation.
Oct 22, 2026	🟩 Reviewer guidelines FULLY UPDATED with new details - please read through the entire document and pay close attention to your role's respective checklists
Oct 20, 2026	🟩 Reviewer and QC checklist are now aligned 🟩Reviewer Checklist: every item now states its fail point in option 4. [Automated] items are scored on the same 1–4 ranges as manual items. 🟩 Studio, Airtable, Mercor and Project Odin being mentioned (item 17) is now OK in the recording and no longer blocks approval. 🟩 Metadata.rtf (item 1): fails when it is under 70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal or Studio. 🟩 Window overlap (item 2): 6–30 s = option 2; over 30 s with no clear effort to fix within time = option 4. 🟩 What / Where / Why (item 3): fails when under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws. An action is anything that changes the state of the document. 🟩 Eyes Closed (item 4): 4 or more ambiguous references is edge case. A 2+ minute stretch narrated mostly with "here" and "this" fails. 🟩 Historical intro-length scoring (former item 8), superseded October 27: removed from reviewer scoring; AutoQC findings are never blocking. 🟩 Metadata.rtf shown (item 9): up to 10 s is edge case; over 10 s fails. 🟩 Typing (item 10): fails over 25% (over 35% for Coding / Content & Writing). 🟩 Historical silence scoring (former item 11), superseded October 27: removed from reviewer scoring; AutoQC findings are never blocking. 🟩 Background noise (item 12): 30–40% of narration = option 2; option 3 = N/A; over 40% fails (option 4). 🟩 Profanity (item 18): minor on-screen profanity not typed by the writer = option 2 and does not block approval; profanity said or typed by the writer, or more than minor on-screen profanity, fails (option 4). 🟩 Domain expertise (item 23): fails when a non-expert could do more than 10% of the actions. 🟩 Pace (item 24): 10–15% of the video above 220 WPM is edge case; over 15% fails. 🟩Missing epilogues DO NOT FAIL tasks regardless of approval date

Date	Details of changes
Oct 19, 2026	🟩 Clarified that CC0, public domain, copyright, royalty free issues only apply to information that ends up in the deliverable.zip. Browsing websites with logos doesn't violate our terms. 🟩Clarified that while ideally project information is hidden (e.g., references to Mercor, Project Odin, Studio Instructions), they will be tolerated in small quantities and should not lead to task rejection on its own. 🟩 Historical announcement — epilogue-length disposition superseded. Epilogue narration requirements: All task ideas originally approved at or after Oct 19, 2026 6PM PT must include an epilogue narration (target: 3-4 mins; maximum: 4:00; longer epilogues may be sent back) which serves as a brief reflection of the work. See here for more details Current reviewer rule: over 4:00 is band 2 (nonfailing) and does not require a send-back on its own. 🟩Reviewer acceptance is up to 54:59 total, including intro and epilogue. Writer recording guidance remains no more than 50:59; the higher acceptance limit is not a writer target.
Oct 17, 2026	🟩 Historical, superseded reviewer-writing arrangement: Clarified Insightful and pay for reviewers who write tasks (Getting Started). Promoted reviewers keep Insightful running and stay hourly while writing; directly hired reviewers do not run Insightful while writing. These historical terms are superseded. Under the October 27 arrangement, reviewers may write when no review work is available, with Insightful off; see Pay & time.
Oct 16, 2026	App-policy update (effective 2026-10-16 18:08 PDT): Historical restriction entries below, including the blanket TextEdit ban, are superseded by the canonical three-category app list. TextEdit may be used for metadata.rtf; separate opening-Goal instructions remain unchanged. In-flight work is protected and now-allowed app rejections may be reconsidered subject to other quality checks.
Oct 14, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list - all tasks submitted before 10/14 5PM PST should be approved if their only failure mode was a restricted app on this list: 1. anatomyapp 2. Autodesk FBX Review 3. Defold 4. drawBook 5. FL Studio / FruitLoops Studio 6. GameMaker 7. JASP

Date	Details of changes
	8. KiCad 9. LTspice 10. Milanote 11. MohrPlotter 12. OpenVSP 13. Penpot 14. qemu-system-aarch64 15. Sticky Notepad 16. Substance 3D Stager 17. TextExpander 18. VMD
Oct 14, 2026	🟩 Added “If the Reviewer raised the complexity issue in R1 and the writer didn’t fix it, then R2 can send back.” 🟩 Added DM templates
Oct 13, 2026	🟩 Added “The goal is to leave 1-2 sentences of feedback” 🟩 Added New Reviewer info: Run Insightful and Device Requirements
Oct 12, 2026	🟩 TextEdit is now fully restricted, including for filling out Metadata.rtf: the restricted app list entry “FOR METADATA.RTF ONLY - TextEdit.app” was changed to “TextEdit.app” (Odin Production Full Workflow world).
Oct 12, 2026	🟩 Full Facelift
Oct 11, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list (Odin Production Full Workflow world): 1. Adobe Express 3. Google Gemini 4. Google Play 5. Kali Linux 6. Screenshot 7. Splice 8. Steam 9. Trading View 10. WPS Office
Oct 10, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list (Odin Production Full Workflow world): 1. Adobe Acrobat

Date	Details of changes
	2. Adobe After Effects 3. Adobe Illustrator 4. Adobe InDesign 5. Adobe Premiere Pro 6. Antigravity IDE 7. App Store.app 8. Apple Music Classical 9. Cisco Packet Tracer 10. CleanMyMac X 11. Complete Anatomy 12. Dictionary.app 13. Font Book.app 14. Games.app 15. GoodNotes 16. GraphPad Prism 17. Linear 18. Magnet 19. Maps.app 20. Mendeley 21. Microsoft Intune 22. Microsoft Store 23. Microsoft Support 24. Music.app 25. News.app 26. NVivo 27. Paprika Recipe Manager 28. Parallels Desktop 29. PDFgear 30. Podcasts.app 31. Shazam 32. Siri.app 33. SnapGene 34. Spotify 35. Substance 3D Painter 36. TradingView 37. UCSF Chimera 38. Wolfram Mathematica

Date	Details of changes
Oct 4, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list (Odin Production Core world): 1. Apple Compressor 2. Apple Motion 3. Final Cut Pro 4. iMovie 5. Keynote 6. Logic Pro 7. MainStage 8. Pages

Reviewer Onboarding

🎯 **After this phase, you will:**

- Understand the steps to get onboarded as a Reviewer
- Have access to all of the tools you'll need

Onboarding Steps

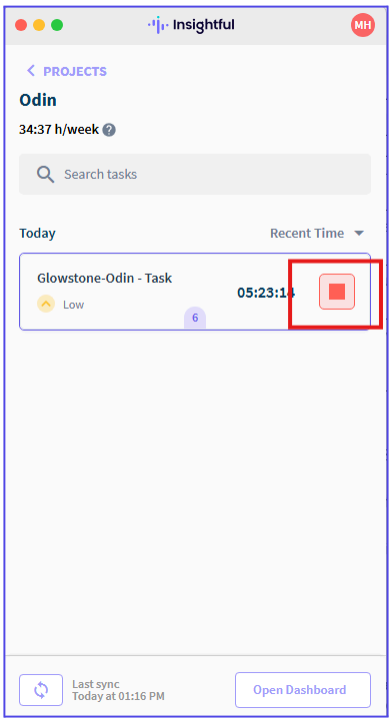
Here is a quick reference guide for how to complete onboarding.

Step	Goal
1 · Insightful	Download the Insightful timer and know how and when to use it
2 · Okta	Access the Okta dashboard
3 · Reviewer Handbook	Read this guide to understand the review process
4 · Quiz	Complete reviewer training. Pass the quiz on the Odin Dashboard unless you qualify for the promoted-writer assessment exemption described below.
5 · Access Studio	How to access and navigate Studio

Insightful

Insightful is used for all of our time tracking, and is how you get paid.

- Once your contract is active, download the Workpuls desktop app from the Insightful download page. Full details on Insightful installation and use can be found here.
- Sign in using Continue with SSO and your @mercor.expert email.
- Insightful has separate Task and Reviewer timers for reviewers. Begin using the Reviewer timer as soon as it appears when reviewing. Do not log writing time on the Task timer.



> ⚠ **Unauthorized Time**
>
> You may only track time when you are actively working. Excess idle time, or time spent on non-project work, is considered fraudulent and will be deducted. You may be offboarded from the project if this occurs- only track time while working on Odin.

Track time only for eligible activities. See the table below.

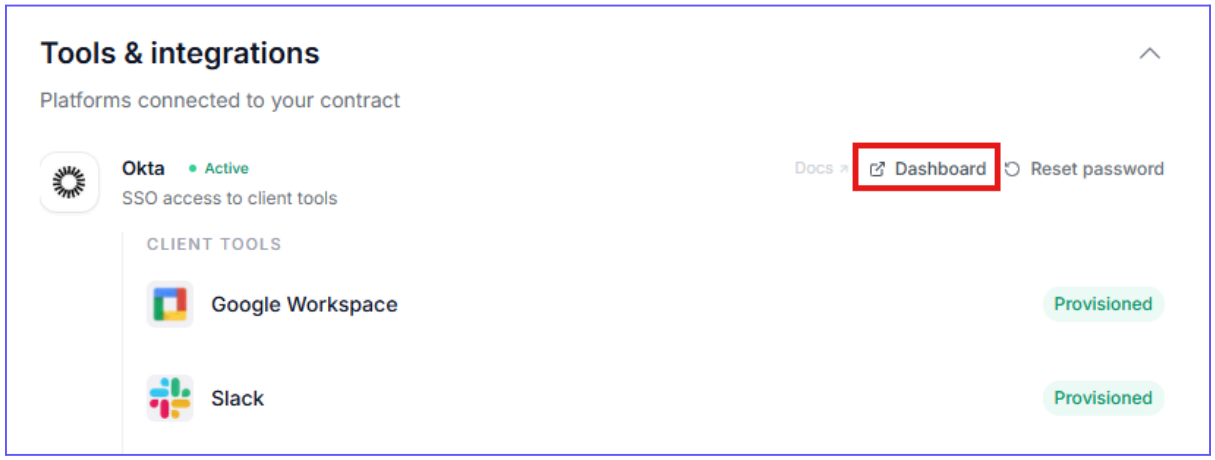
✅Ok to Track	❌ Do not track
Reviewer onboarding and completing the reviewer training and quiz.	Sitting idle or waiting for new tasks or meeting attendees without an authorized, paid duty.
Reading the review guidelines and required project updates within your allowed hours.	Sitting idle watching Slack in case something is posted.
Required reviewer training and approved project meetings.	Working for a non-Odin project.
Approved reviewer office hours or review-related support - **max 2 hrs weekly**, on the “Admin” timer.	Optional office hours or other optional calls.

Reviewing and re-reviewing assigned tasks, including evidence checks and file corrections.	Breaks, social media, unrelated websites, personal tasks
Writing complete feedback in the writer-facing Studio field and sending the required writer DM.	Resolving non-blocking personal technical issues or waiting for access to project tooling.
Actively participating in necessary review-related Slack discussions.	Chit-chatting with other experts in Slack.
Other explicitly approved reviewer duties.	Waiting for Maven or another AI tool to return an answer.

Okta

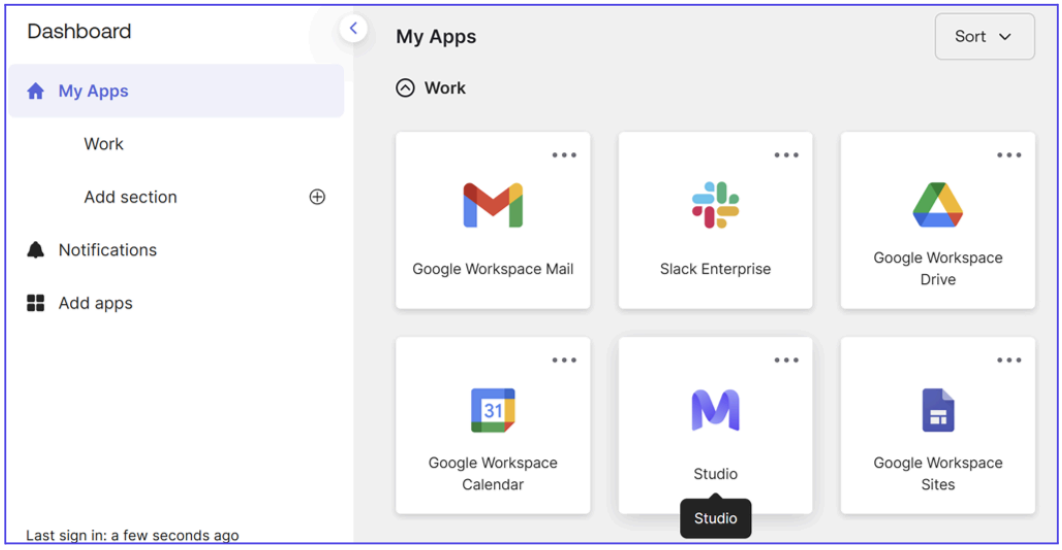
The Okta Dashboard is accessed by logging in to your account at work.mercor.com, using your personal email and password.

- Click ‘Home’ on the left toolbar, then ‘Contracts’. Find and click your Odin contract.
- Scroll to ‘Tools & Integrations’, find Okta, and click the Dashboard link.



- When prompted to add a verification method, use the Passkey option, and set one up for your account by following the steps.

- You will be taken to the Okta dashboard where you can access your Slack app, Studio, and your Google Workspace Mail, which will display your mercor.expert account.



- To access project documentation, you **must** be logged in to a browser using your mercor.expert account.
- Once you have logged in to Okta, you can do this by setting up a new Google profile, pasting in your mercor.expert email address, and clicking next- it will log in with the SSO.

> 💡 **Okta issues**
>
> For access issues not covered in this guide, please email support@mercor.com.

Reviewer Handbook

This guide is your single source of truth for the reviewing process. Please ensure you review it in full before you begin reviewing!

> 💡 **No Mac required**

> Reviewers do not need to have a Mac to complete reviews on Project Odin. If you wish to write tasks as well, you will need a Mac.

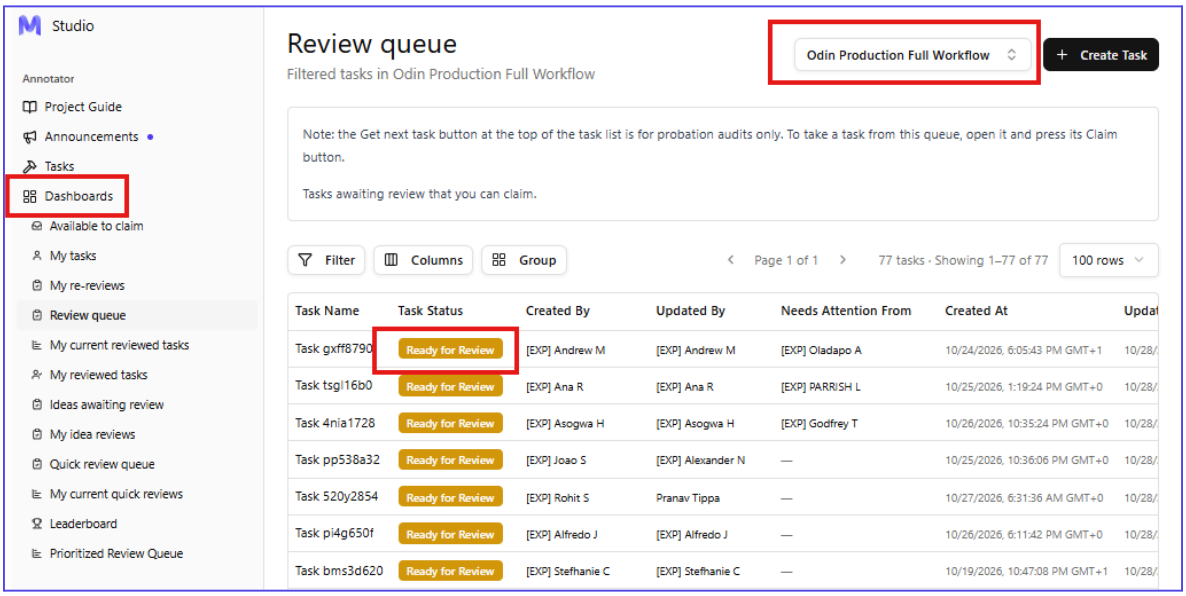
Reviewer Assessment

To become a reviewer, complete the training and pass the assessment on the Odin Vercel Dashboard. Promoted writers with first-pass approvals on four of their last five tasks are exempt from the assessment.
The reviewer assessment includes:

- 2 mock reviews
    - Watching a short task
    - Completing a review checklist
    - Writing your feedback
- Narration check
    - Watch a 40-second task snippet with no audio
    - Type out a transcript of what good narration would sound like in the snippet
- You can only take the assessment once, and the results will determine if you become a reviewer or not.
- If you do become a reviewer, your starting tier will be decided based on your score on the quiz. See more information in Roles & Pay.
- If you do not pass the assessment and do not have your role automatically returned to “writer” after an hour, or simply do not wish to be a reviewer, fill in the Pay & Role Request Form to return to the Writer role.

Studio

When you have passed the quiz, you should get reviewer access to Studio within 30 minutes.
Inside Studio, you will see the Reviewer Dashboards available on the left side, and the worlds available in the top right drop down menu.



💡 No review tasks?

Review tasks are claimed quickly! If you open the dashboard and there are no tasks available, refresh the page, or check the other dashboards. Once you are off probation, you can review in **Review Queue, Quick Review Queue**, and **Ideas Awaiting Review**.

Reviewer Role

🎯 **After this phase, you will:**

- Know the expectations for reviewers
- Understand the different reviewer tiers
- Know the pay associated with the role

Reviewer Expectations

Reviewers are always expected to communicate with the writers using collaborative, respectful language.

- An important part of your role as a reviewer is to help the writers **to improve**- not to simply point out what they've done wrong.
- As a reviewer, you are **setting the tone**. Approach every interaction as a collaborative discussion, not a top-down correction.

Good feedback is essential on this project. Follow these general guidelines:

Item	What it means
Start with the positive	Acknowledge what the writer did well
Be specific	Clearly explain each issue with the task. Include a timestamp and specific example.
Provide clear, actionable feedback	Suggest a path to improvement

When providing feedback, we ask our reviewers to follow a specific template to allow for as much alignment as possible and to improve clarity. There are additional message templates in the Feedback Templates section.

💡 **Good Communication**

> Clear, respectful communication is the foundation of our workflow. It improves our work, our team morale, and our overall project speed! Early in the project, Reviewers are essential to help **calibrate/motivate** writers, and this interaction can set the whole tone for their experience.

Reviewers are expected to maintain good efficiency standards. All reviewers should aim for:

- <45 minutes per review, on average, while ensuring quality remains high.
- At least 15 hours of work per week, to ensure tasks continue to turn over.
- A review pass rate of 30% or higher- that is, that at least 30% of your reviews result in approvals.
    - You are responsible for ensuring only high quality tasks are approved, and also for helping to coach writers to improve so this rate can be achieved.
- A reviewer defect rate <10%.

> 💡 **Reviewer Defect Rate**
>
> A defect is recorded against you when an auditor **reverses** your review decision at the QC audit stage. For example, if you approve a task and the auditor decides it Needs Edits, that review counts as a **defect**.
>
> Defect rate = (# of defects + 1) ÷ (audited reviews + 10), expressed as a percentage.
>
> Example: You have one audited review, which is a defect.
>
> (1 + 1) ÷ (1 + 10) = 2/11, or about 18%.

Pay Policy

Your contract will determine your base rate.

For eligible hourly-paid tasks, time tracked within your stage allowance or weekly limit is paid. Idle or off-project time, and hours above your limit, are not paid.

Payment schedule

- Hourly pay is sent every Wednesday for the previous week (Friday 11:30 am PT - Friday 11:29 am PT following week).
- Tier bonuses are normally paid the Wednesday after the corresponding hourly pay, but may arrive earlier, including with the hourly payment. Tier bonuses are the amount paid above the base hourly rate in your contract.
- First payout: Verification may add 3-5 business days.
- Possible delays: Bank holidays, processing schedules, and bank cutoffs may delay settlements.

Payment providers

- **Stripe:** The primary payment platform for ongoing contributors. After accepting a job offer, follow the instructions to create your payout account.
- **Wise:** Generally used for one-time payments, contributors who have not completed Stripe onboarding, or contributors whose bank accounts are in countries Stripe does not support. You don't need a Mercor account to receive payment through Wise. Follow the instructions to set up Wise.

Roles & Pay

Reviewers are divided into three tiers, each with different pay rates and hours: Probation, Standard, and Trusted. Tiers are reviewed once a day at 00:00 India time, and reviewers will be moved into the appropriate tier and notified of the change. Each tier applies to the whole India-time day (11:30am PT - 11:29am PT.

⚠️Probation	
Summary	**Details**
Base Pay: The hourly rate in your contract **Bonus Pay:** None **Total Pay:** The hourly rate in your contract **Available Hours:** 6 hours **Hours roll over:** Never	○ If you passed your Reviewer training/quiz with a mid-range score, you begin in this tier. ○ You will complete 2 reviews, which will be audited. ○ If both pass, you move to the Standard Tier. ○ If either fails, you complete a further 2 audited reviews. ○ If either of those fail, you return to being a Writer.

✅Standard

Summary	Details
Base Pay: $55/hour **Bonus Pay:** None **Total Pay:** $55/hour **Available Hours:** 80 hours **Hours roll over:** Weekly	○ If you passed your Reviewer training/quiz with a high score, you begin in this tier. ○ You may also move up from Probation to this tier if your first reviews pass audit. ○ This is the standard reviewer tier, but you may move to the Trusted tier if your work is high quality.

🎯Trusted	
Summary	**Details**
Base Pay: $55/hour **Bonus Pay:** +$20/hour **Total Pay:** $75/hour **Available Hours:** 80 hours **Hours roll over:** Weekly	○ You may move up from Standard to this tier if you are a high quality, efficient reviewer. ○ Reviewers are eligible for this tier with: ○ 10+ reviews ○ AHT <45 min on your last 10 reviews ○ Lifetime defect rate under 10%

Effective October 22, 2026 at 3:00 p.m. Pacific (PDT). Hours worked around the cutoff use the rate applicable when the work was done.

Reviewers are also able to write when there is no review queue.

- Use the Reviewer timer when reviewing. Begin using the Reviewer timer as soon as it appears; Do not log time on the Task timer.
- When there are no tasks in the review queue, you can also write!
- All reviewers are paid $100 + $2/minute for each task that reaches RFD. Do not log time on Insightful when writing.

Review Workflow

> 🎯 **After this phase, you will:**
>
> - Understand how the review types differ
> - Know how to claim tasks for review and the rules
> - Understand the full workflow for each review type

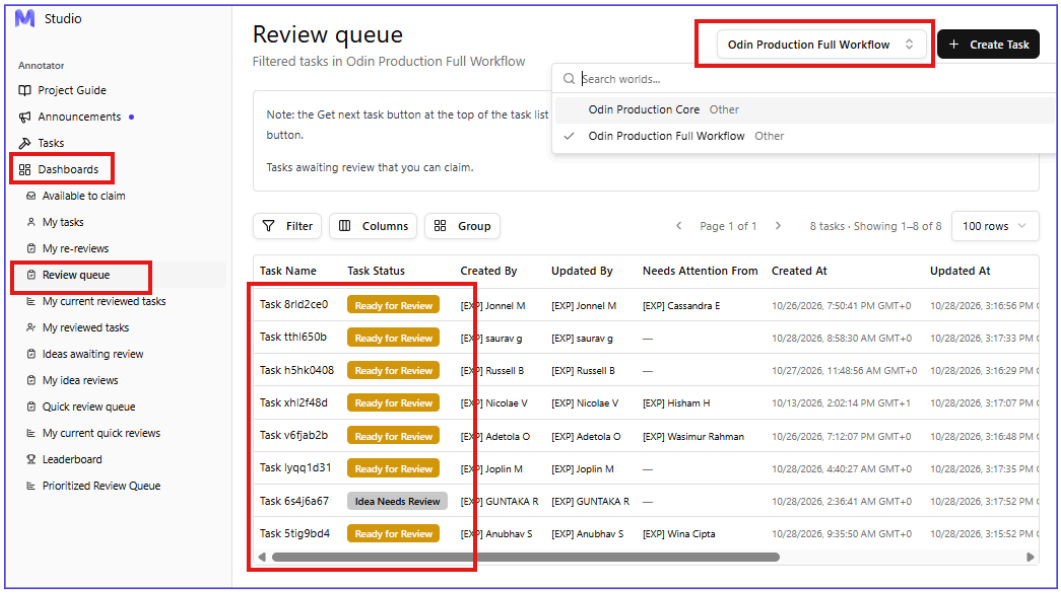
Orienting with Studio

You will conduct all reviews inside Studio, which you can access via Okta.

When you click the Studio tile, it will open this page.

Key components:

- **Dashboards:** Dropdown menu on the left side where you can access the different Reviewer Dashboards.
- **World:** Dropdown on the top right corner. You will have access to two worlds.
    - Odin Production Core world- Original world. Very few tasks left to review.
    - Odin Production Full Workflow world- New world. Most tasks will be found here.
- **Main task section:** Once you have clicked a dashboard, the tasks will appear in the middle of the page.



General Review Guidelines

Project Odin has 3 different types of reviews. The general process for each of these reviews is the same.

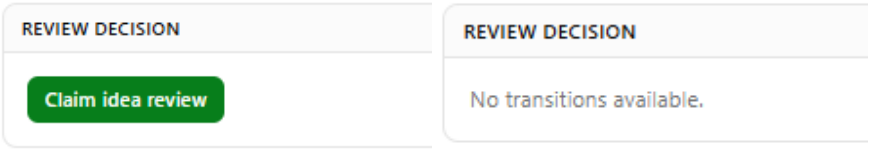
Review Type	What it is	Where to find it
Idea	Reviews initial ideas before the writer starts recording.	Review Queue
Full	Tasks that require all 14 dimensions to be reviewed.	Prioritized Review Queue
Quick	Shorter reviews that only have 6 dimensions to check.	Quick Review Queue

> 💡 **On probation? Full or Quick Reviews only!**
>
> If you are on probation as a reviewer, please only perform Full or Quick Reviews until you reach Standard Reviewer status.

Claiming Reviews

Reviewers are expected to complete reviews in the same sitting in which they are claimed.

- Always aim to complete a review within 1 hour of claiming it. AHT should remain <45 minutes overall.
- Do not claim more than 2 reviews at a time.
- Tasks held in review for >2 hours are at risk of being released back to the queue.
- If you need more time, you can extend it by ticking the ‘Extend review claim’ box.
    - This should be used sparingly- we monitor how often reviewers use it.
- If you need to step away and cannot finish a review, you should release it.
- To claim a review in any of the workflows, click an available task, scroll to the bottom, and click the ‘claim’ button in the left tab.



- If you get to the bottom and it says ‘No transitions available’, this just means someone else has already claimed it.

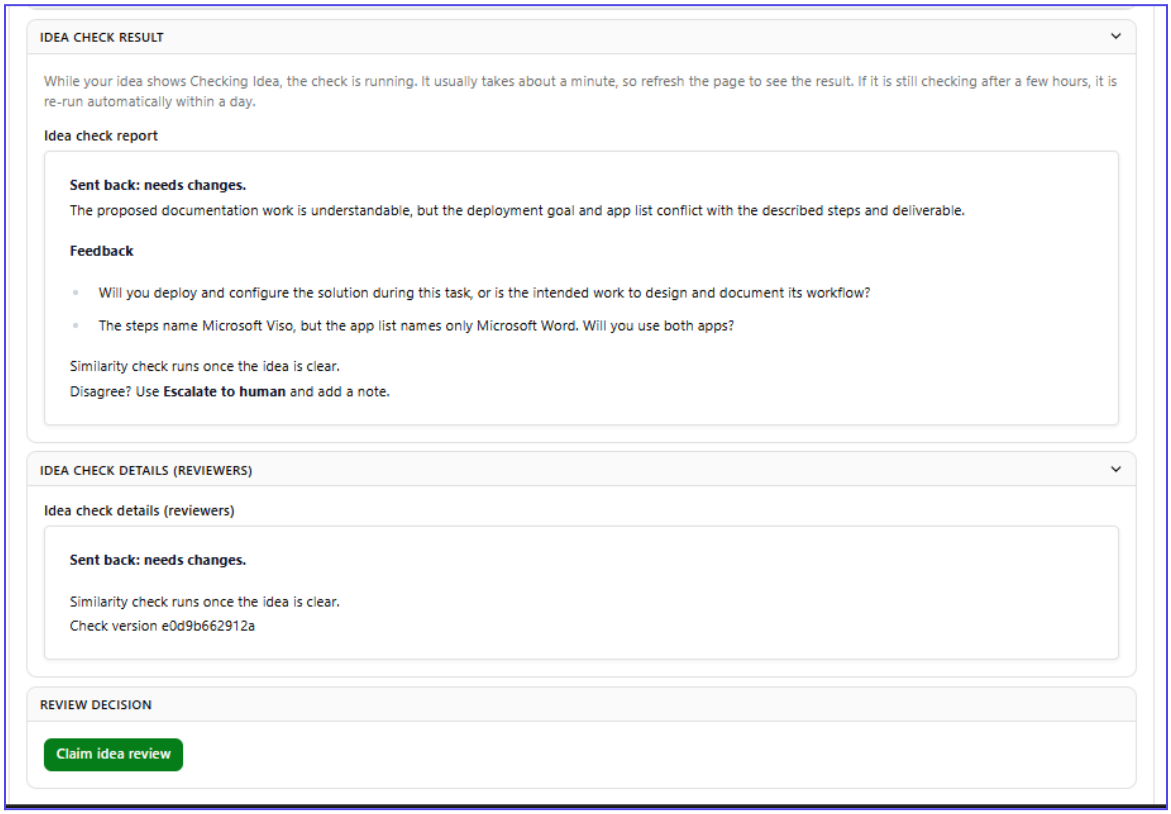
> ⚠ **Do not hold on to reviews**
>
> Reviews should be completed in the same sitting they are claimed. Do not claim tasks in order to reserve them for later. The ‘Extend review claim’ box should only be used if you are waiting for technical guidance/support, never to save a review for another time.

Idea review

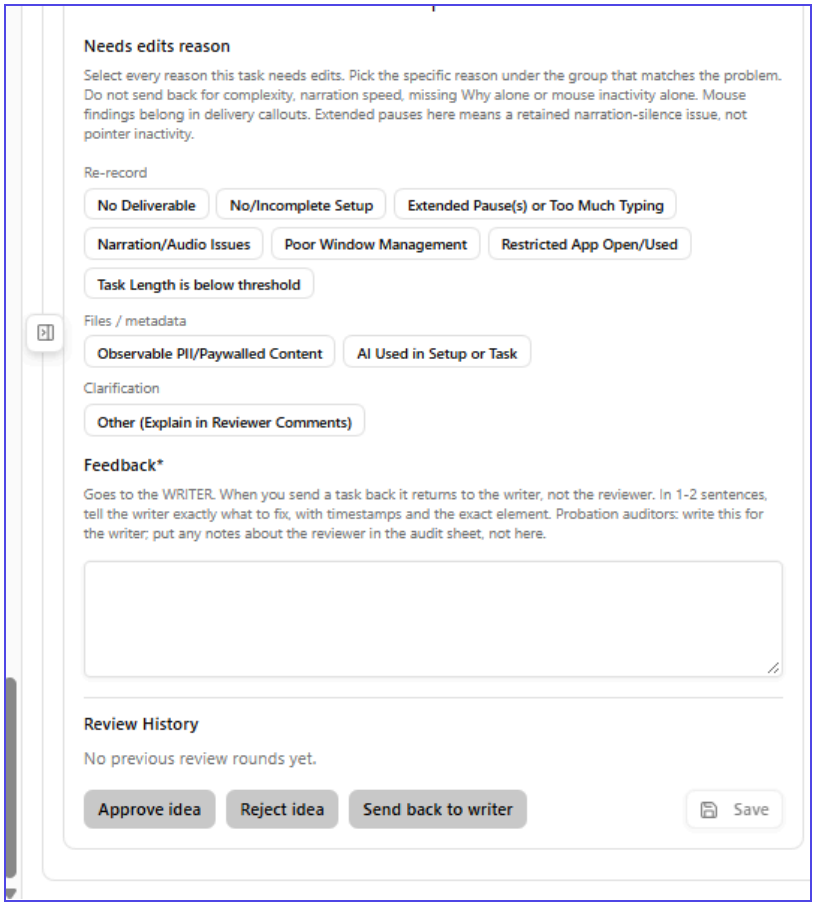
Idea reviews are found in the main Review or Ideas awaiting review dashboards.

- Idea checks are mostly automated. Distinct ideas are approved automatically so the writer can start recording.

- Ideas the model can't verify or that the writer has escalated appear as Idea Needs Review in the review queue.
- Once you have claimed the idea review, read through the goal, starting point, suggested apps, and reviews and checks.
- You will see the report with details from the automated check in the ‘Idea Check Report’ section.



- On the right side of the page, you can add your Feedback to support your decision in the feedback section.
- You can then click ‘Approve idea’, ‘Reject idea’ or ‘Send back to writer’ if you believe it just needs some minor edits.
- Reject ideas only if you are convinced they are entirely outside project guidelines and will need to be completely redone.



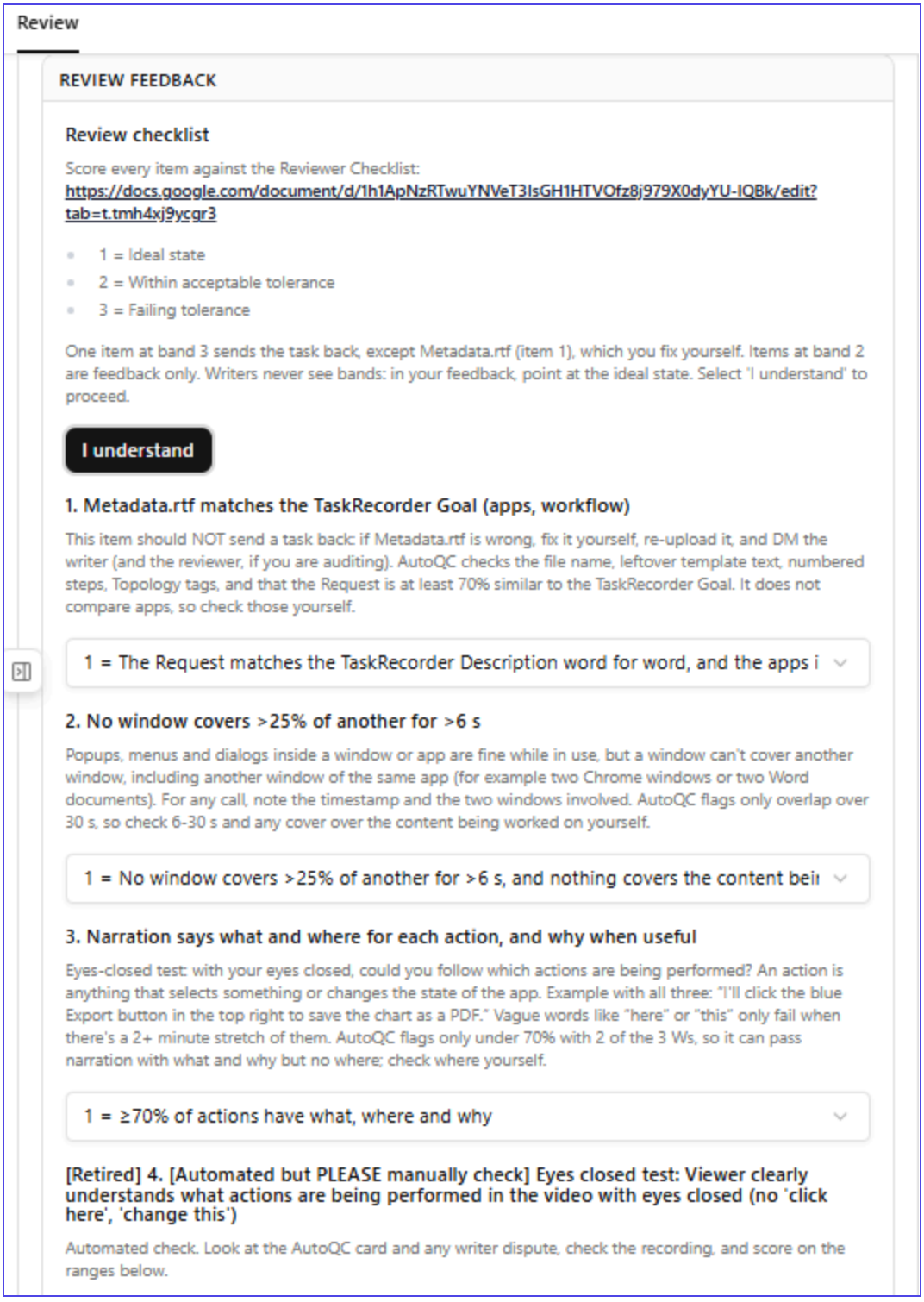
Full review

When conducting full reviews, check several dashboards. Always check in this order:

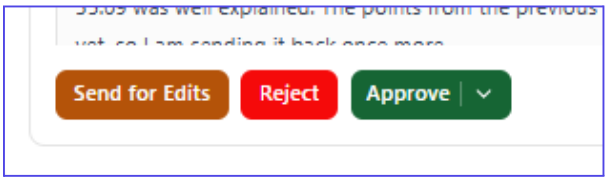
- My re-reviews- Tasks that have come back to you for another review.
- Prioritized Review Queue- Higher priority tasks.
- Review Queue- The normal review queue.

On the right side of the page, inside the task, you'll score 14 dimensions as either 1 (ideal), 2 (acceptable), or 3 (failing). Please see Reviewer Checklist for more details on how to score each dimension. For metadata, review the file in Metadata.rtf Upload.

- Make sure you download the Deliverables.zip file and open and review all of the input files.
    - Confirm every input, artifact, and final output seen on screen is in it
    - AutoQC only checks file names



As with all review types, you can select whether to approve, send for edits, or reject a task at the bottom on the right side, with these buttons:

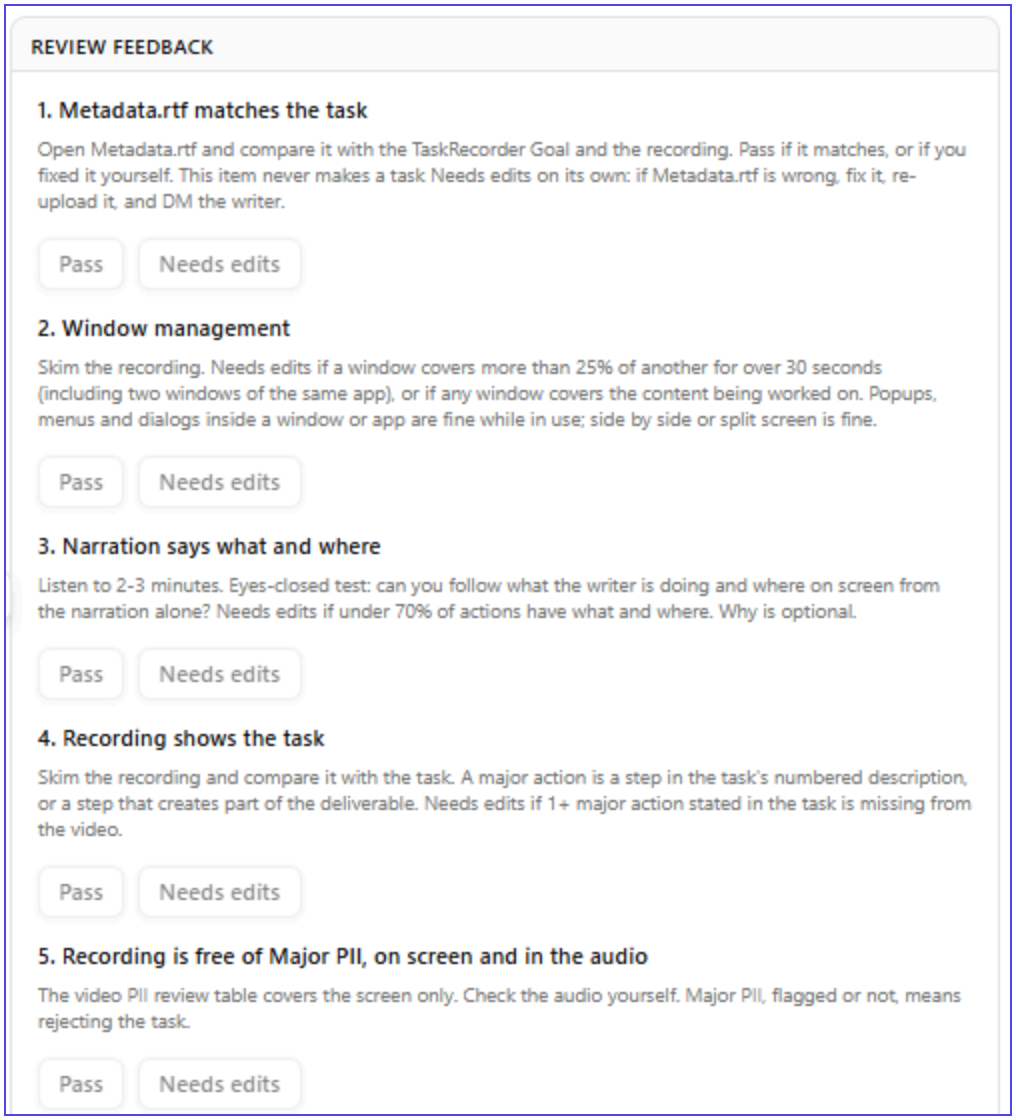


> 💡 **When to reject**
>
> You should rarely reject tasks- this will discard them. Reject should be used only when **explicitly** instructed; in the vast majority of cases, you will send it for edits instead.
>
> Tasks can only be reviewed 3 times. After the 3rd review, if it is not approved, reject it instead of sending it back.

Quick review

Some tasks will be routed to the Quick review queue. Quick review is a more focused review process that targets the main areas that AutoQC misses.

These tasks have 6 dimensions to review: Metadata.rtf Upload, window management, narration, task match, personal information and licensing.



These operate on a simpler tagging system instead of scoring from 1-3.

- Check each dimension carefully and select ‘Pass’ or ‘Needs edits’, based on the guidance in the Reviewer Checklist section.
- Also review the AutoQC checks on every task, and any disputes written by the writers.
- Open deliverables.zip: every downloaded asset needs a CC0, public domain or Gemini-generated source in Final Notes. AutoQC does not check licensing, and an asset from the Canva library or a stock site (Pixabay, Pexels, Unsplash and similar) is a send-back.
- If you notice other issues that would warrant sending the task back, please send it for edits, even if they are outside the 6 dimensions checked. Issues

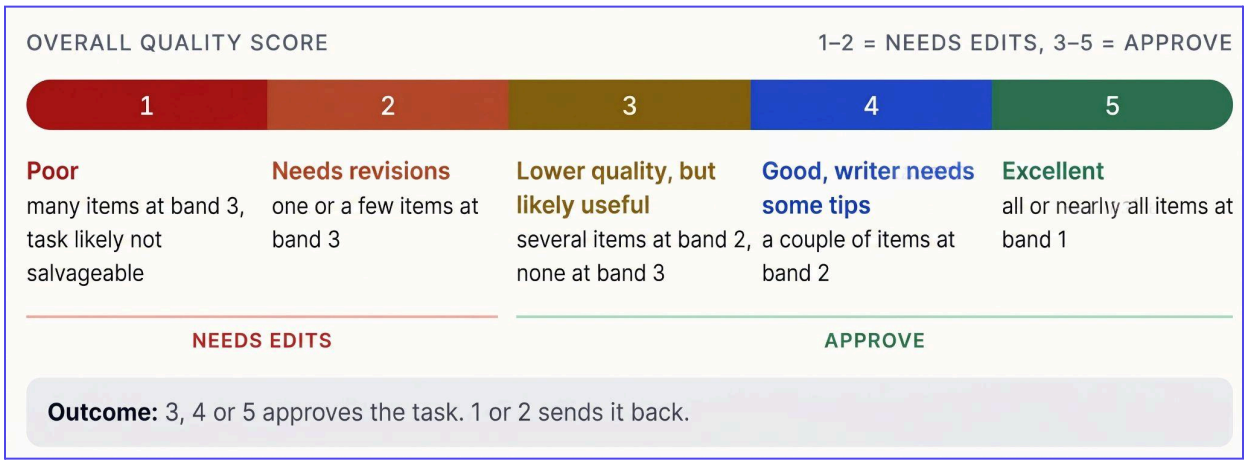
QC finds outside these 6 dimensions are not counted against the quick reviewer.

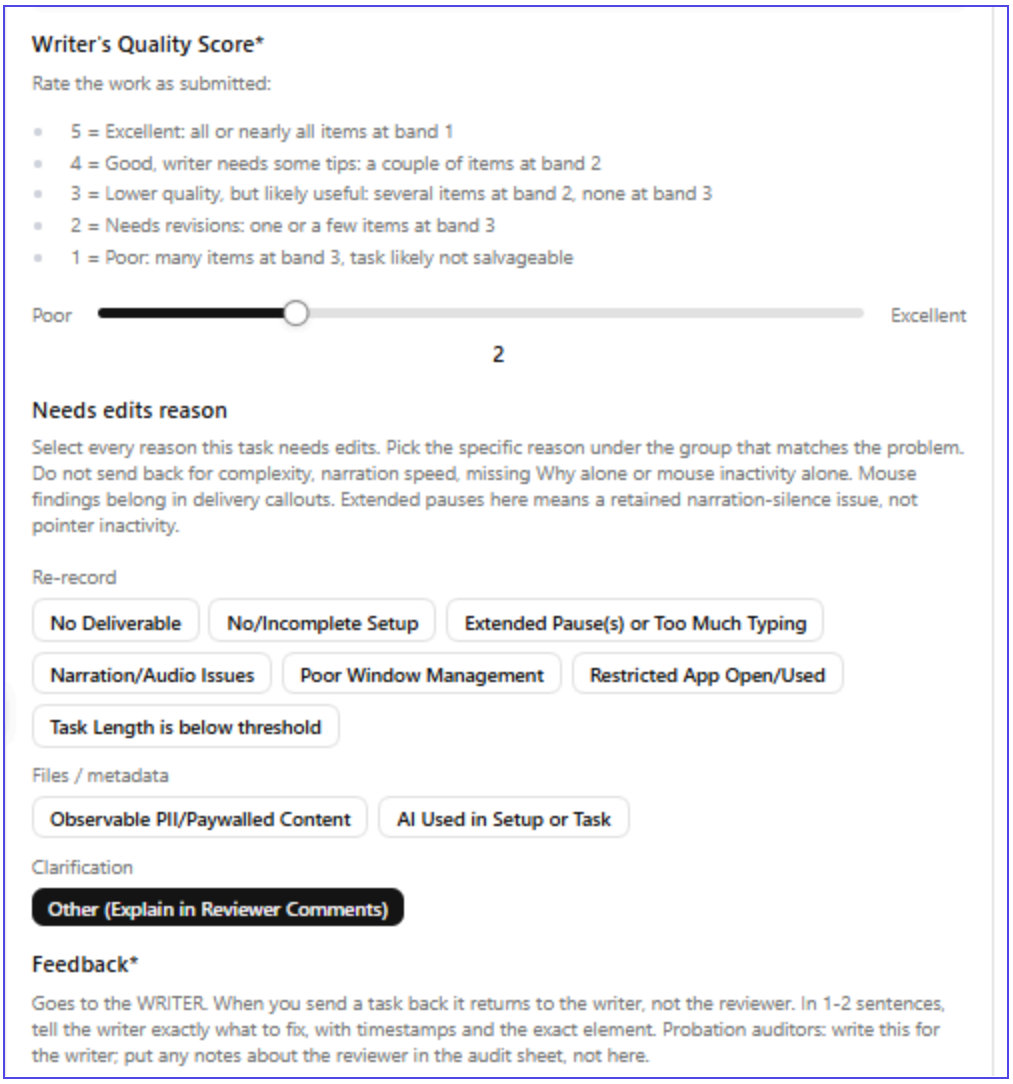
- These should be faster- ideally 30-40 minutes or less.

Completing your review

After every dimension has been given a score of 1-3 (or scored ‘Pass’ or ‘Needs edits’ in Quick Reviews), you can move on to the rest of the review.

- Select an overall quality score using the toggle, from 1 to 5.
- Be aware that on this scale, 1 is the worst score, and 5 is the highest!





- If sending for edits, select a reason from those given, or select ‘Other’ and explain.
- Always leave a detailed review in the writer-facing ‘Feedback’ section.
    - Review the communication expectations, and make use of the Feedback Templates to ensure good feedback is provided.
    - Always ensure you include timestamps and examples in the feedback.
- Add Internal Notes: These are notes that the writers will not see. They are for QC and EPMs only.
    - Pro tip: If you find yourself making a judgment call on an edge case, explain your reasoning for approving the task in the Internal Notes.

> **💡 Good feedback is crucial!**
>
> As a reviewer, part of your role is to ensure the writers receive constructive, detailed feedback, with timestamps and examples, to help them improve.
>
> Your role is not only to ensure tasks are high quality- helping to calibrate the writers is also very important.
>
> Always add the feedback directly in the task, AND send a message to the writer via DM on Slack.

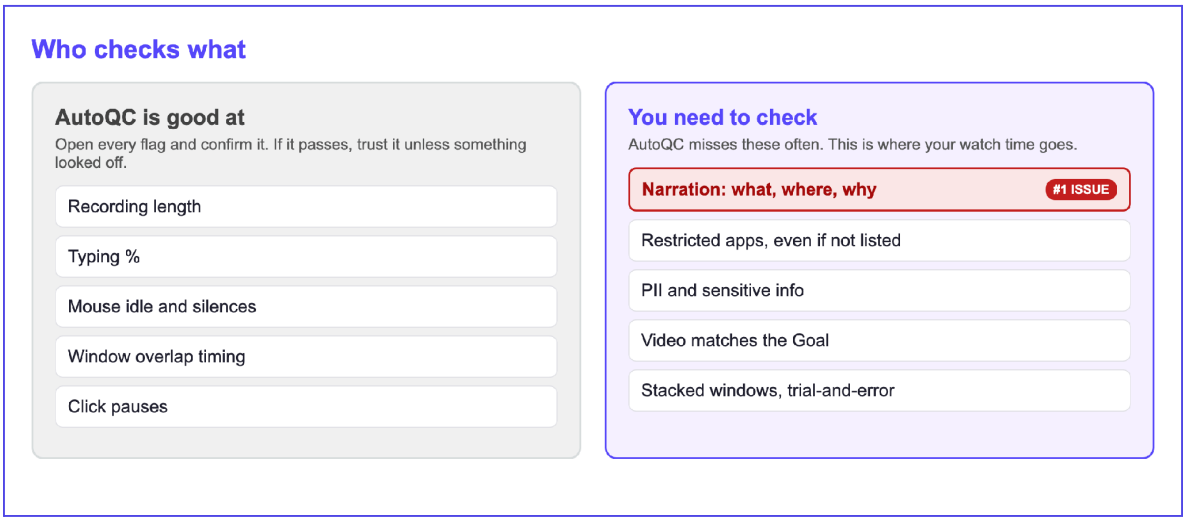
Review Efficiency

There are several things you can do to improve your efficiency and speed up the review process, while maintaining quality.

Quick tips:

Try:	But remember:
✅ Watch the recording in 1.5x or 2x speed.	Check in 1x to make sure narration is paced well.
✅ Use AutoQC as a quick check for quality.	Make sure key issues are addressed.
✅ Focus your time on what AutoQC misses.	Good narration is crucial- make sure it is checked.
✅ Cut time if you know early on the task needs to be sent back.	Do a quick check of the rest of the task so you can flag other major issues.
✅ Always fix minor issues yourself.	This saves time overall if it doesn't need another review.

Keep in mind what AutoQC is good at, and focus your attention elsewhere.



Other ways to save time:

- Start loading the video as soon as you claim the task. Check the Goal and Metadata.rtf Upload while it buffers.
- Use AutoQC flag timestamps to go straight to the moment in question.
- Keep feedback short. One line per issue with a timestamp and the fix.
- Pay attention to narration! Watch for vague words like "this", "that", "here".
- If it is a re-review, check what the previous reviewer's comments were, and focus on these areas first.

💡 Live captions in Chrome

To assist with your review of the video, try using live captions! Click the three dots in the top right of the browser, and select Settings. On the left sidebar, click Accessibility, then Turn on Live Captions, and make sure to select English.

💡 Narration

Narration is by far the most common quality issue. It is the top reason writers get sent back, and the top issue QC finds in tasks reviewers approved. Give it most of your attention.

Does it explain **what** is happening, **where** on screen, and **why**? Would it pass the eyes-closed test (could you follow along without seeing the screen)?

QC audits

Use this workflow when you are assigned to QC. Audit the task and the reviewer's work, complete the full checklist, and leave feedback that lets the writer fix all required issues in one pass.

Reviewer Checklist · QC audit channel

Claim and complete a QC audit

1. Claim a task from Awaiting Final QC. It moves to In QC Review. Finish the audit in one sitting where possible; follow current queue assignments from your lead.

2. Watch the full recording and review the input files, deliverables, Metadata.rtf Upload, AutoQC results and any disputes. Complete the entire QC even if you find a send-back issue early. The review efficiency shortcut does not replace a full QC audit.

3. Score every item below against the recording and files. Use AutoQC as evidence to verify, not as the verdict. Judge narration clarity at 1× speed and use the reported AutoQC typing percentage and task type for item 7.

4. Compare the reviewer's checklist, decision and feedback with your findings. Correct editable file issues yourself where the checklist permits it. Record reviewer coaching in Internal Notes and DM the reviewer; flag repeated misses to an EPM.

5. Enter the bands in the Review checklist card, then complete Writer's Quality Score, Feedback and, when sending for edits, Needs edits reason. Writer's Quality Score is a separate 1–5 scale: 1 is worst and 5 is best; it is not the checklist's 1/2/3 tolerance scale. Save complete writer-facing feedback, send the required writer DM, and choose QC Approved, Needs QC Revision or Rejected as appropriate. Check the resulting status. If you need extra time for a blocker, check with an EPM and use Extend Review Claim.

QC checklist — the same 14 items as reviewer checks

Use the same item order, tolerance bands and exceptions as 06. Reviewer Checklist. The table below reproduces that checklist. Its additional privacy, licensing, AI and file guidance also applies.

1 = ideal state; 2 = within acceptable tolerance; 3 = failing tolerance. Binary rows allow 1 or 3 only. Any failing item requires edits except item 1: fix Metadata.rtf yourself and replace it in Metadata.rtf Upload. Item 14 has no failing band; a missing epilogue uses the unscored “Missing epilogue — does not block approval” response.

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
1. Metadata.rtf matches the TaskRecorder Goal (apps, workflow).	The metadata.rtf Request matches the TaskRecorder Description word for word, and the apps in the Task Description and TOPOLOGY fields match the TaskRecorder apps.	The Request wording differs but keeps every key idea, and the apps match.	Key ideas differ, or the apps do not match.	If this scores a 3, do not send the task back. **Correct the file yourself and replace it in Metadata.rtf Upload.**
2. The content being worked on remains visible.	No window covers >25% of another for >6 s, and no window covers any part of the content being worked on.	A window covers >25% of another for 6-30 s, and no window covers any part of the content being worked on.	A window covers >25% of another for >30 s, or a window covers any part of the content being worked on.	Minor window overlap alone is not an error and does not require edits or a re-record. Two tabs belonging to one window of the same app are

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
				not separate windows. For any call, note the timestamp and the two windows involved.
3. Narration says what and where for each action, and why when useful.	≥70% of actions have all 3 Ws (what, where, why).	≥70% of actions have what and where (why optional).	Under 70% of actions have what and where. Missing where fails. (A narration with what and why, but no where, now fails.)	Eyes-closed test: with your eyes closed, could you follow which actions are being performed? An action is anything that selects something or changes the state of the app. Example with all three: “I'll click the blue Export button in the top right to save the chart as a PDF.”
4. Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task.	All major actions stated in the task are in the video, and deliverables.zip has every input file used and the final output.	N/A	The video is missing 1+ major action stated in the task, or deliverables.zip is missing an input file used in the task or the final output.	A major action is a step in the task's numbered description, or a step that creates part of the deliverable. An input file is one the writer opened or used in the task; websites

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
				visited only for research don't count. AutoQC only checks file names, so open deliverables.zip and compare it with the recording.
5. The menu bar clock shows seconds at the start and end of the video.	Yes	N/A	No	Check the first and last few seconds; it doesn't need to be visible in between.
6. The Goal document (task description) is shown at the start of the recording, then promptly minimized.	Yes	N/A	No	The Goal document can't be shown in Notes.app or TextEdit; Preview and other apps are fine.
7. Typing takes up 25% of the video or less (35% or less for Coding / Content & Writing tasks).	≤25% of the video (≤35% for Coding / Content & Writing)	N/A	>25% of the video (>35% for Coding / Content & Writing)	Use the AutoQC typing % and task type; do not estimate by hand.
8. The narration can be understood on first listen.	You can follow everything the writer says without replaying.	N/A	You have to replay or guess to understand what is happening in	Tip: turn on Chrome Live Caption (Chrome Settings >

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
Background noise, mumbling, speaking too fast, a strong accent or broken English only matter when they get in the way of understanding the video. Loud typing is fine if the narration stays clear.			the video, because of noise, mumbling, pace or unclear speech.	Accessibility > Live Caption) and play the video. **If the captions pick up what the writer is saying, that is a good sign it is clear.** Many auditors have found this helpful. Judge clarity at 1x speed.
9. The recording is free of disallowed AI use.	No AI used.	Only allowed AI: reading Google AI Overview with no follow-ups, autocomplete, or SWE/ML code that is part of the task.	Any prompting or chatting with AI, AI Mode, Google "Ask anything", or an AI feature doing real task work (for example Photoshop subject select).	Escalate unclear cases, such as passive enhancement features. Apply Privacy rules in the Writer Handbook, or the LLM section in this document.
10. The recording is free of personal information (PII), both on screen and in the audio.	Yes	N/A	No	Apply Privacy rules in the Writer Handbook, or the PII section in this document.
11. Deliverable assets meet licensing requirements.	Yes	N/A	No	Apply licensing rules in the Writer Handbook or brief details in this

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
				guide. Merely browsing a website with a trademarked logo does not fail.
12. The narration and everything on screen are free of profanity.	Yes	Minor profanity on screen, not said or typed by the writer	Profanity said or typed by the writer, or major on-screen profanity	Minor: a mild word on a webpage or file the writer did not create. Major: slurs, explicit content, or anything prominent on screen.
13. Narration must be fully in English, and deliverables must be in English.	Yes	N/A	No, or cannot verify	Minor amounts of non-English content on screen are acceptable.
14. Recording includes an epilogue narration of 4:00 or less before recording stops: a narrated summary of how the task was verified, the approach, challenges,	4:00 or less, with real detail.	Over 4:00, or lacks detail (nonfailing).	N/A	A missing epilogue never sends a task back: use the unscored "Missing epilogue — does not block approval" response instead of a band. Ideas first approved before Oct 19, 2026, 6pm PT

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
quality and reflections.				don't need an epilogue, even after later revision.

Apply the exceptions consistently

Metadata.rtf: correct the Request, numbered Task Description and tagged Topology, keep the file in .rtf format, and replace it in Metadata.rtf Upload. Metadata errors alone never send the task back. A Metadata.rtf/TaskRecorder Goal mismatch is an audit pass, not a reviewer audit failure; explain the correction in Internal Notes and DM the writer and reviewer.

Intro length, silence duration and click pacing are advisory only. Mouse inactivity is an unscored, timestamped Internal Note. Missing, long or thin epilogues follow item 14. These do not block approval on their own.

Minor window overlap alone is not an error. Apply item 2's exact criteria, distinguish separate windows from tabs in the same window, and record the timestamp and windows involved when making a call.

Review the actual workflow and output against the approved idea. Low complexity alone is not a send-back reason. Use the Reviewer Checklist's Quick Reference Guide for other fix-and-approve, send-back and reject rules.

Privacy and licensing sweep

Scrub to the start, every app or window change, every save or export dialog, and the final minutes. Check app account corners, the browser profile, Finder sidebar, file paths, Terminal prompts, autofill, recent-file lists and notification previews. Listen for personal information as well as checking the screen.

Apply item 10 and the detailed PII rules in Reviewer Checklist. Real personal emails, home addresses, phone or account numbers, personal photos or biometrics are not allowed. A brief exposure still needs review; do not ignore it

because it appears in only one frame. The listed exceptions still apply, including @mercor.expert email/account names, public figures or profiles, obvious fake example details and the writer's first name.

A brief glimpse of the words Mercor or Odin alone is allowed. Showing Studio, Insightful or Odin Slack is a separate prohibited exposure: project tools and project-administration documents must not appear in the recording.

Inspect assets inside the deliverables, not just the websites visited. Images, videos and other downloaded assets must meet the CC0/public-domain requirements; royalty-free alone is insufficient. Apply the public-repository license exceptions, Gemini-watermark exception and other detailed licensing rules in Reviewer Checklist. Merely browsing a site with a trademarked logo does not fail. Escalate unclear licensing before deciding.

Manual checks that AutoQC does not replace

Check these points even when the automated result is green. Use the current checklist for bands and exceptions; the following are evidence checks, not additional scored items.

Item 1 — Metadata: check the file name, leftover template text, numbered Task Description steps, LOOKUP/CREATE/MODIFY tags, Request text, and app sequence. Compare apps and workflow yourself, then correct the .rtf file and replace it in Metadata.rtf Upload.

Item 2 — Windows: check visibility of the content actually being worked on, as well as the amount and duration of overlap. In-app dialogs, pop-ups, menus and toolbars are exceptions while in use. Record the timestamp and the windows involved.

Item 3 — Narration: check What and Where coverage for actions that select something or change the app state, not just edits to the document. What and Why without Where does not meet the acceptable band. Use the eyes-closed test.

Item 4 — Workflow: verify every major action promised in the task, including steps that create the deliverable, and confirm the final output is shown and saved during the recording. Also confirm deliverables.zip has every input file used and the final output.

Items 5–6 — Start and finish: check the menu-bar seconds in the first and last moments, and verify that the Goal document appears at the start and is promptly minimized. Apply the current Goal-document app requirements.

Item 7 — Typing: use AutoQC's reported percentage and the correct task type. The applicable limits are 25%, or 35% for Coding / Content & Writing; equality is within tolerance. Do not estimate the percentage by hand.

Item 8 — Audio: listen at 1× speed and judge first-listen understanding. Noise checks or live captions are aids, not substitutes for listening. Loud typing is fine when narration remains clear; do not invent a words-per-minute failure threshold.

Items 9–14 — Manual review: inspect AI use, PII, licensing, profanity, English narration/deliverables and the epilogue directly. Do not assume an automated pass has cleared them. The epilogue has no three-minute minimum; apply item 14's maximum, detail requirement and nonblocking missing response.

Other flags: check required files are uploaded and readable; video duration; deliverable names; final output saved on video; TaskRecorder fields; Accessibility Inspector; UI changes; app-use restrictions; and work on unrecorded screens. Also review Dock, mouse-idle and background-app flags against the Quick Reference Guide. These findings do not create new checklist bands.

Record the band for every active item. For each finding below ideal, include a timestamp where applicable, or the file/field location for a non-temporal issue. Use the row's tolerance criteria rather than creating a separate severity ranking. Describe any AutoQC mismatch in the feedback with the evidence.

AutoQC and reviewer checks

For every AutoQC flag or dispute, compare the claim with the recording or file. Explain whether you agree with a dispute. A green result does not establish band 1, and advice flags do not create additional failing checklist items.

Check that the reviewer completed all required items, validated AutoQC, reached the right decision for the right reasons, and described every failing dimension with a specific example and a timestamp for each temporal issue. Keep reviewer coaching out of the writer-facing field.

If Studio's checklist or a blocking flag conflicts with this guidance, save the task link, exact field or flag, and supporting evidence; ask in the QC audit channel. Do not invent a replacement threshold or assume the platform has been corrected.

Feedback

Leave feedback on every task, including approvals. Separate required fixes from growth notes. Writers do not see checklist bands, so describe the issue, evidence, ideal target and fix without band numbers or tolerance thresholds. Include enough detail to cover every required correction.

Writer-facing feedback template
Audit | <your name> | <date> Must fix before approval: <list, or none> <Checklist item name> | <timestamp or file location> | <what you observed> Target: <the ideal behaviour> To fix: <the specific change required> Growth notes: <nonblocking advice, or none>

Worked example: required fixes and growth notes

Too vague: "Narration is weak and there's too much dead air. Sending it back."

Audit | <your name> | <date>

Must fix before approval: What/Where narration.

Required fix — narration | 06:41, 09:15 and 14:02. You say "now I change this value here" without naming the field or value. A listener cannot follow those actions with eyes closed. Name each action and its exact on-screen location, and explain why when useful.

Growth note — silence | 12:04–13:20. The recording is silent for 76 seconds while a build runs. For future tasks, narrate what you are waiting for during a long-running step. Silence duration does not block approval.

Why it matters: the narration should let someone follow the actions without seeing the screen.

To fix: name the field and the value each time you change it. Treat the waiting-time narration as advice for future tasks.

Insightful for QC audits

Activity	Timer / action
QC audits, including evidence checks, file corrections, decisions, feedback and required task messages	QC timer while actively working.
Regular reviews or re-reviews	Stop the QC timer and use the Reviewer timer.
Approved reviewer office hours or review-related support	Admin timer, up to 2 hours per week under the reviewer office-hours/support allowance.
Idle time, waiting for tasks, AutoQC or replies, breaks, personal tasks, or unrelated work	Stop the timer. A task staying claimed is not active work.

Use the Workpuls desktop app, sign in through SSO with your @mercor.expert account, and select the correct Odin timer. Stay within your approved hours. If the required timer is missing or broken, pause hourly work and report the exact issue for EPM help; do not substitute another work category.

Other eligible audit duties include required paid onboarding or training, reading required guidance and updates, approved project meetings, necessary audit-related Slack discussions, and assigned corrections or follow-up. Use the timer category confirmed for that activity. Do not track passive Slack monitoring, access waits, personal technical troubleshooting, other-vendor work or waiting for AI replies.

Insightful installation and use

QC pay and role terms

Effective October 22, 2026 at 3:00 p.m. Pacific (PDT), Standard QC is $75/hour base ($75 total). Trusted QC is $75/hour base plus a $5/hour tier bonus ($80 total), in USD. Hours around the cutoff use the rate applicable when the work was done.

Your contract shows the base rate; the tier uplift is paid separately as a bonus. Confirm your own tier, contract and approved hour allowance. Doing an audit does not itself grant a QC contract or extra hours, and separately announced incentives keep their own eligibility and dates.

For a QC rate or tier discrepancy, use the QC pay-announcement thread with the relevant contract and work details. Use Reviewer Expectations for the payment schedule and Reviewer FAQ for payment, role and access request forms.

QC FAQs

Can I stop once I know the task needs edits?

No. Watch the full recording and finish the checklist. Give the writer all required fixes in one pass.

How is QC AHT calculated?

The target is under 45 minutes on average per completed QC. Policy assessment pools the last seven complete Pacific calendar days: eligible logged QC hours × 60 ÷ completed QC decisions in that window. Do not average daily AHTs. Dashboard filters do not change the policy window. This is an average, not a per-task cutoff; record active eligible work accurately.

Do metadata mistakes fail the reviewer audit?

A Metadata.rtf/TaskRecorder Goal mismatch is an audit pass. Fix and replace the file in Metadata.rtf Upload, note the correction, and DM the writer and reviewer. A materially different recorded workflow is a separate issue; a metadata edit cannot repair it.

Where can I find QC resources and report repeated problems?

Use the audit calibration thread for uncertain decisions, with the task link and what you are unsure about. The QC Resources canvas also contains team logistics and tracker links. Repeated reviewer misses should be flagged to an EPM; the Low Quality Review Report form is available for reporting review quality.

What if I am unsure about AI, licensing, PII or an AutoQC flag?

Check the detailed rules in Reviewer Checklist, then ask in the QC audit channel with the task link, relevant timestamps and your proposed decision before deciding.

What if I switch from QC to regular reviews?

Follow your current queue assignment, stop the QC timer and start the Reviewer timer. Do not leave the QC timer running while waiting for another audit.

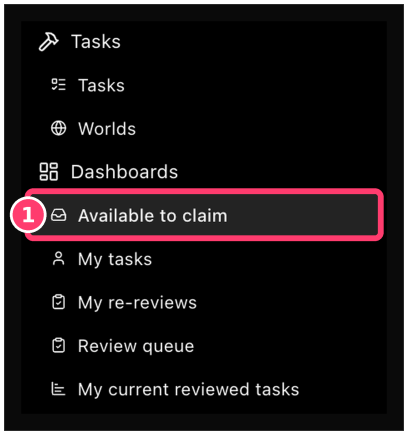
Probation audits

For auditors checking probation reviewers. Review the task independently, compare the reviewer's decision and reasoning, then release the held task. Your chosen outcome also records the audit result for the reviewer.

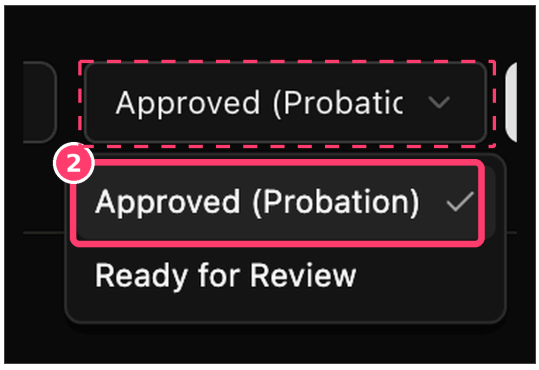
Reviewer Checklist · Review Workflow · Probation audit channel · Status-correction thread

Claim your next audit

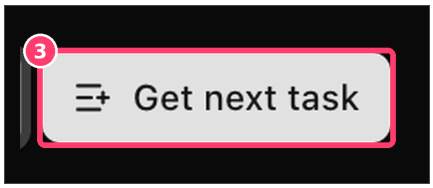
1. Open Available to claim under Dashboards in the left sidebar.



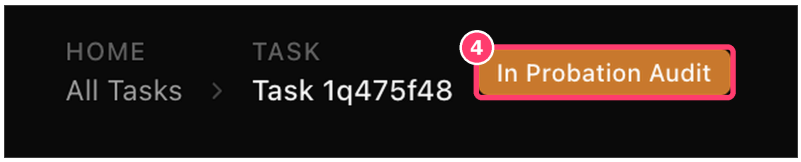
2. Set the status filter to Approved (Probation), not Ready for Review.



3. Click Get next task. Studio assigns the oldest waiting task. You cannot choose which one; you claim an individual review, not a reviewer.



4. Confirm the task is In Probation Audit (orange, beside the task ID). Hold one probation audit at a time. Use Unclaim Audit if you cannot finish; an untouched claim returns to the queue automatically.



Follow current queue instructions for your assignment. When assigned probation audits, prioritise that queue and return to it when tasks become available. If it is empty, take eligible regular reviews as directed by your lead.

A held send-back can appear as Waiting for Audit; held approvals and rejections appear as Approved (Probation). The writer cannot act until release. Tasks can also release when the reviewer's standing is decided; if one disappears mid-audit, move on to an available task.

Audit the task, then the review

Form your own verdict first using the current 14-item Reviewer Checklist and its Quick Reference Guide. Apply the same tolerance criteria and exceptions used in ordinary review; probation auditing does not introduce a stricter QC checklist.

Check the recording, files, AutoQC flags and disputes. Resolve stale or disputed flags against the evidence. A genuine unresolved blocking issue makes an approval incorrect; intro length, silence duration, click pacing and other advisory-only findings do not block approval on their own.

Check the reviewer's decision, reasoning and complete writer-facing feedback. Did they identify the important issues and give a timestamp, specific element and actionable fix? A correct send-back can still fail an audit if it missed a major issue or left the writer without usable instructions. Minor misses alone, or extra

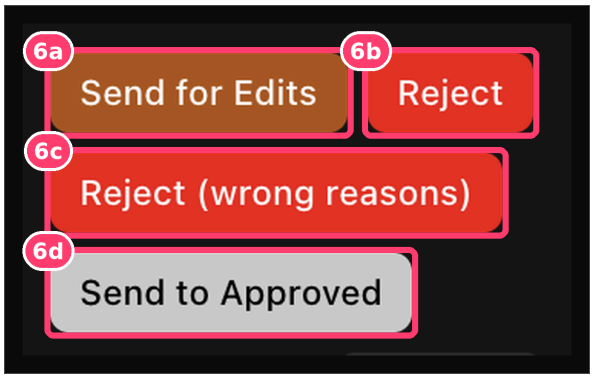
nonblocking advice alongside the correct blocking issue, do not fail it. If feedback went by DM only, ask the reviewer for it before deciding.

Correct the final Metadata.rtf yourself and replace it in Metadata.rtf Upload. A Metadata.rtf/TaskRecorder Goal mismatch is an audit pass, not a reviewer audit failure. Explain the correction and notify the writer and reviewer. Compare the recorded workflow and final output with the approved idea; low task complexity alone is not a reason to send back.

Check that the final output is shown in the video and saved during the recording. If the video never shows the final output, send it for the required fixes. Compare the work with the approved idea rather than adding a separate complexity bar.

Choose the outcome

Example decision controls



The screenshot shows example controls. Use the outcome table below for the full set of decisions and wrong-reasons cases; the available buttons depend on the task's state.

Agree means the decision and reasons were correct. A plain button matching the reviewer's decision records a pass. Any wrong-reasons button, or a different decision, records a failed audit. Select the button for the correct task outcome; Studio records the reviewer result as part of that action.

What you found	Result	Button
Reviewer approved, the task is approvable, and the reasons are right	Agree	Send to Approved
Reviewer approved and the task is approvable, but they missed something blatant or the reasoning was wrong	Disagree	Send to Approved (wrong reasons)
Reviewer approved but the task needs fixes	Disagree	Send for Edits
Reviewer sent it back, the issues are real and the feedback is actionable	Agree	Send for Edits
Reviewer sent it back correctly but missed something blatant, or the feedback would not help the writer	Disagree	Send for Edits (wrong reasons)
Reviewer sent it back but the task was approvable	Disagree	Send to Approved
Reviewer rejected, and the rejection and reasons are right	Agree	Reject
Reviewer rejected correctly but for the wrong reasons	Disagree	Reject (wrong reasons)
Reviewer rejected but a send-back was enough, or the reverse	Disagree	Send for Edits or Reject, whichever is right

Use “wrong reasons” for blatant misses or incorrect reasoning, not minor omissions. If the reviewer caught the important issues and the writer can act on the feedback, use the plain matching button. Ask in the probation audit channel before clicking if the case is unclear.

Feedback and follow-up

After every audit, DM the reviewer whether you agreed or disagreed. Include the task link, Agree/Disagree result, what they got right, and what they missed or got wrong. Name the current checklist item, include timestamps where relevant, and explain the fix you expected.

Reviewer DM template
Task: <link> Audit result: <Agree / Disagree> What you got right: <specific observations> What to improve: <checklist item, timestamp and expected fix, or none> Task outcome: <approved / edits / rejected>

Keep any required writer corrections in the writer-facing Studio feedback and send the required writer DM. Reviewer coaching belongs in Internal Notes and the reviewer DM. Confirm the resulting task status after submitting.

Insightful for probation audits

Activity	Timer / action
Auditing a probation review, checking evidence, correcting files, choosing the outcome and sending required feedback	QC timer while actively working.
Doing an ordinary Full or Quick review	Reviewer timer, including when you yourself are a probation reviewer.
Approved reviewer office hours or review-related support	Admin timer, up to 2 hours per week under the reviewer office-hours/support allowance.
Waiting for an audit, new tasks, AutoQC, access or replies; breaks and unrelated work	Stop the timer.

Auditing a probation reviewer and doing your own probation reviews are different activities: auditors use QC; reviewers use Reviewer. Switch timers when switching duties. Stay within your approved hours. If the required timer is missing or broken, pause hourly work and report it for EPM help.

Other eligible audit duties include required paid onboarding or training, reading required guidance and updates, approved project meetings, necessary audit-related Slack discussions, and assigned corrections or follow-up. Use the

timer category confirmed for that activity and stay within your approved allowance.

Check your role and hour allowance in work.mercor.com → Home → Contracts → Odin. Doing a probation audit does not itself change your contract, tier or rate. Use the rate and allowance confirmed for your assignment; if you are assigned as a Reviewer, the reviewer terms apply.

Insightful installation and use

Probation audit FAQs

The decision was correct. When is “wrong reasons” appropriate?

Only when a blatant miss, incorrect reasoning or unusable feedback makes the review defective. It is not for minor misses. A valid send-back can include extra nonblocking feedback without failing the audit.

Do I send a reviewer DM after a passing audit?

Yes—after every audited task. State the result and what was done well, along with any useful improvement feedback.

Why is Send to Approved greyed out?

AutoQC may need fresh results. Wait a few minutes with the timer paused if you are only waiting. If it remains unavailable, post the task link and exact state in the probation audit channel.

What if I clicked the wrong outcome or lost feedback?

Use the status-correction thread. Include the task link, current status, intended status and one line explaining the correction. An EPM handles the change. If the task is already with the writer, it cannot be pulled back through this correction flow; DM the writer instead.

Does a passing audit mean the reviewer has passed probation?

A single passing task is not the reviewer’s final probation outcome. Reviews are assessed in pairs, with at most four reviews while awaiting feedback. Use the probation rules in the Reviewer FAQ and confirm the reviewer’s recorded outcome before telling them their role or allowance has changed.

Where do I ask about a judgment call?

Use the probation audit channel with the task link, checklist item, evidence and proposed result. Ask before clicking when unsure. For an AutoQC or form mismatch, include the exact flag or field instead of treating an advisory issue as a failure.

Reviewer Checklist

🎯 **After this phase, you will:**

- Understand the 1/2/3 quality scale for reviewing
- Understand all the different items to score for each task
- Have access to the Quick Reference review decisions table

Reviewer Checklist

Below is the Project Odin Reviewer checklist that will be used to verify the quality of tasks on Project Odin. When reviewing a task, you will be selecting which tolerance criteria have been met for each checklist item, which is on the following scale:

- 1 = Ideal state
- 2 = Within acceptable tolerance
- 3 = Failing tolerance



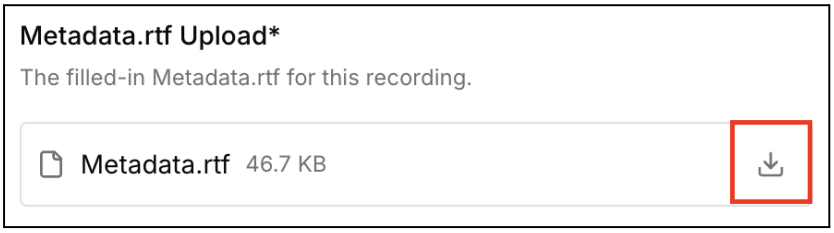
Some checklist items have binary tolerance criteria: they either fulfilled it (1 = Yes) or they failed to meet it (3 = No). Other checklist items have a range which is described within each checklist item.

> ⚠ **Any score of 3 = Send back**
>
> A single item in this checklist which scores a 3 will require the task to be sent back. The only exception is item 1 (Metadata.rtf matches the TaskRecorder Goal)- because you can, and should, correct the Metadata.rtf file yourself.

Metadata.rtf

Studio generates Metadata.rtf draft from the approved idea. The writer downloads it, checks and edits it, then uploads the final file in Metadata.rtf Upload.

- Review the file in Metadata.rtf Upload; the draft alone does not count as the final upload. Open it in a text editor, keep it in .rtf format, fix any errors yourself, then replace and verify it in the same field.
- **Request:** the Goal section of the approved idea, exactly as approved. Nothing else.
- **Task Description:** a numbered, step-by-step outline of how the writer will complete the task.
- **Topology:** the apps in the order used, each tagged LOOKUP (reading or finding, no changes), CREATE (making something new) or MODIFY (changing something that exists). Apps can repeat. Example: Safari (LOOKUP) → Excel (CREATE) → GraphPad Prism (CREATE)



Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
1. Metadata.rtf matches the TaskRecorder Goal (apps, workflow).	The metadata.rtf Request matches the TaskRecorder Description word for word, and the apps in the Task Description and TOPOLOGY fields match the TaskRecorder apps.	The Request wording differs but keeps every key idea, and the apps match.	Key ideas differ, or the apps do not match.	If this scores a 3, do not send the task back. **Correct the file yourself and replace it in Metadata.rtf Upload.**
2. The content being worked on remains visible.	No window covers >25% of another for >6 s, and no window covers any part of the content being worked on.	A window covers >25% of another for 6-30 s, and no window covers any part of the content being worked on.	A window covers >25% of another for >30 s, or a window covers any part of the content being worked on.	Minor window overlap alone is not an error and does not require edits or a re-record. Two tabs belonging to one window of the same app are not separate windows. For any call, note the timestamp and the two windows involved.
3. Narration says what and where for each action, and why when useful.	≥70% of actions have all 3 Ws (what, where, why).	≥70% of actions have what and where (why optional).	Under 70% of actions have what and where. Missing where fails. (A narration with what and why, but	Eyes-closed test: with your eyes closed, could you follow which actions are being performed? An action is anything that selects

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
			no where, now fails.)	something or changes the state of the app. Example with all three: “I'll click the blue Export button in the top right to save the chart as a PDF.”
4. Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task.	All major actions stated in the task are in the video, and deliverables.zip has every input file used and the final output.	N/A	The video is missing 1+ major action stated in the task, or deliverables.zip is missing an input file used in the task or the final output.	A major action is a step in the task's numbered description, or a step that creates part of the deliverable. An input file is one the writer opened or used in the task; websites visited only for research don't count. AutoQC only checks file names, so open deliverables.zip and compare it with the recording.
5. The menu bar clock shows seconds at the	Yes	N/A	No	Check the first and last few seconds; it doesn't need to

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
start and end of the video.				be visible in between.
6. The Goal document (task description) is shown at the start of the recording, then promptly minimized.	Yes	N/A	No	The Goal document can't be shown in Notes.app or TextEdit; Preview and other apps are fine.
7. Typing takes up 25% of the video or less (35% or less for Coding / Content & Writing tasks).	≤25% of the video (≤35% for Coding / Content & Writing)	N/A	>25% of the video (>35% for Coding / Content & Writing)	Use the AutoQC typing % and task type; do not estimate by hand.
8. The narration can be understood on first listen. Background noise, mumbling, speaking too fast, a strong accent or broken English only matter when they get in the way of understanding the video. Loud typing is fine if the narration stays clear.	You can follow everything the writer says without replaying.	N/A	You have to replay or guess to understand what is happening in the video, because of noise, mumbling, pace or unclear speech.	Tip: turn on Chrome Live Caption (Chrome Settings > Accessibility > Live Caption) and play the video. **If the captions pick up what the writer is saying, that is a good sign it is clear.** Many auditors have found this helpful. Judge clarity at 1x speed.

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
9. The recording is free of disallowed AI use.	No AI used.	Only allowed AI: reading Google AI Overview with no follow-ups, autocomplete, or SWE/ML code that is part of the task.	Any prompting or chatting with AI, AI Mode, Google "Ask anything", or an AI feature doing real task work (for example Photoshop subject select).	Escalate unclear cases, such as passive enhancement features. Apply Privacy rules in the Writer Handbook, or the LLM section in this document.
10. The recording is free of personal information (PII), both on screen and in the audio.	Yes	N/A	No	Apply Privacy rules in the Writer Handbook, or the PII section in this document.
11. Deliverable assets meet licensing requirements.	Yes	N/A	No	Apply licensing rules in the Writer Handbook or brief details in this guide. Merely browsing a website with a trademarked logo does not fail.
12. The narration and everything on screen are free of profanity.	Yes	Minor profanity on screen, not said or typed by the writer	Profanity said or typed by the writer, or major on-screen profanity	Minor: a mild word on a webpage or file the writer did not create. Major: slurs, explicit content, or anything

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance	Notes
				prominent on screen.
13. Narration must be fully in English, and deliverables must be in English.	Yes	N/A	No, or cannot verify	Minor amounts of non-English content on screen are acceptable.
14. Recording includes an epilogue narration of 4:00 or less before recording stops: a narrated summary of how the task was verified, the approach, challenges, quality and reflections.	4:00 or less, with real detail.	Over 4:00, or lacks detail (nonfailing).	N/A	A missing epilogue never sends a task back: use the unscored "Missing epilogue — does not block approval" response instead of a band. Ideas first approved before Oct 19, 2026, 6pm PT don't need an epilogue, even after later revision.

Quick Reference Guide

Below is a quick reference table for when to approve, fix and approve, send back, or reject a task.

Issue	Action	How

Any Metadata.rtf error (Request, topology, apps, mismatch with Goal or TaskRecorder)	FIX + APPROVE	Fix and replace the file in Metadata.rtf Upload; explain in Studio feedback + Slack DM. Never send back for metadata alone.
TaskRecorder description missing or mismatched, and it's the only error	FIX + APPROVE	Once metadata.rtf matches the Studio goal: Internal Note + Edge Case checkbox.
Non-restricted app unlisted, or listed but unused	FIX + APPROVE	Fix editable files; if the field is locked, add an Internal Note. A materially different workflow still needs edits.
Deliverable file name slightly off	FIX + APPROVE	Rename it yourself.
Brief glimpse of the names Mercor or Odin	APPROVE	No note needed.
Intro length is above the ideal 20s, silence above 45s, or rushed clicks	APPROVE	Provide feedback.
One typing segment over 45s, typing at exactly 25%/35%	APPROVE	Provide feedback.
Dock not visible, Dock is at bottom but with a UI change, TaskRecorder window visible	APPROVE	Provide feedback. UI change can be wallpaper (not the macOS default), light/dark mode, Dock size, colours, resolution, icon size, theme. Cursor size and colour must stay default.
Minor overlap, content still visible	APPROVE	Score item 2 by its thresholds.

Mouse inactivity	APPROVE	Timestamped Internal Note.
Epilogue missing / over 4:00 or thin	APPROVE	Use the unscored “missing” response / band 2 + growth note.
Video is 50:59–54:59, single-app task, low task complexity	APPROVE	No deduction for these alone.
TaskRecorder window not shown at the start	APPROVE	Possibly a recorder bug. Review as normal and add an Internal Note.
Any checklist item 2–13 at band 3	SEND BACK	Send-back template, with timestamps.
Confirmed there is an app-use violation. Check the Writer Handbook for the source of truth list.	SEND BACK	Name the app, the prohibited use and timestamps.
Workflow or deliverable materially different from the approved idea	SEND BACK	Fixing the metadata can’t repair this.
Resubmitted with no changes	SEND BACK	Point to the original note.
Accessibility Inspector not running / no UI element changed	SEND BACK	At least one UI element needs to be changed, and Accessibility Inspector must be running.
Studio, Insightful or Odin Slack on screen	SEND BACK	Project materials cannot be shown on the recording.
Missing or unreadable files (including a missing input file or final output in	SEND BACK	Send back with suggestions.

deliverables.zip), video outside 15:00–54:59		
Concept can't be fixed within the approved scope	REJECT	If unsure, send back instead.
Still needs writer changes after review #3	REJECT	Tasks have a maximum of 3 reviews. If it can't be approved on review 3, it should be rejected.
Unclear AI feature, licensing or PII	ESCALATE	#odin-reviewers-hub for advice if you aren't sure.

Additional review rules and guidance

Below are some additional things to keep in mind while reviewing.

Check for good narration

Use What, Where, and Why

For each meaningful step, the writer should say **what** they are doing, identify the control and **where** it is on screen, and explain the **purpose or result** when it is not obvious.

The cursor should be on the correct place on the screen while they are narrating the navigation, to ensure they match.

Element	Purpose
What	The action being taken
Where	The exact app, control, file, value, or interface location

Why	The purpose or what happens after the action, when it is not obvious

> 💡 **Listen for ‘there’ and ‘that’**
>
> Too many instances of ‘here’ or ‘there’ or ‘this’ or ‘that’ may indicate writers have not narrated the what/where/why successfully. See the Examples tab for good narration examples.

Also ensure the audio is generally good quality, with low background noise, that each step is narrated, and it is well-paced rather than moved through too quickly.

Manage Windows Clearly

Writers must manage their windows properly, with one clear active window, or having them arranged with the needed windows side by side. Other task apps may remain open, but minimize them when not needed for the current step.

> 💡 **Window management**
>
> App windows must be open in only a single layer on-screen with minimal overlap, otherwise Accessibility Inspector can't accurately communicate to TaskRecorder which UI elements the cursor is passing over or selecting. In-app dialogues, pop-ups, menus, and toolbars will always be an exception to this for practical reasons.

Personally Identifiable Information (PII)

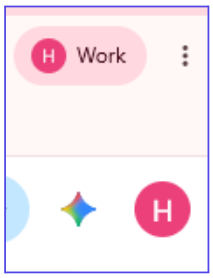
You can check quickly for PII by scrubbing to each app/window change and looking for any of the below issues.

✅ Ok to include	❌ Not ok to include
Your @mercor.expert email and account name	Other real account or identification numbers
Public figures or public profiles	MAC addresses, or a Mac serial number + an IPv6 address

Mentioning Mercor or Project Odin aloud	Showing any Project Odin tools or documents
Obviously fake names, emails, and phone numbers (John Smith, JohnSmith@example.com, 123-456-7890)	Personal emails, home addresses or phone numbers of real people
Your first name	Personal photos or biometrics

There are several places PII can slip in, and recordings which include them will need to be re-done. Pay particular attention to:

- **App profile corners.** The writer's name or photo in the top-right account area of PowerPoint, Word, Google Docs, Sheets or Slides, or the browser's profile button.
    - An initial in the corner of Chrome, with no personal photo, is ok.



← This is ok!

- **Usernames in paths.** The writer's full name in the Finder sidebar, a window title, a save or export dialog (/Users/yourname/...), or the Terminal prompt.
- **Logged-in accounts.** A personal email or profile photo in Chrome, Gmail, Google Drive or any web app.
- **Autofill and history.** The writer's name or email in search suggestions, recent-file lists, or notification previews.

Also ensure no Project Odin tools or documents ever show on screen. This includes:

- The Project Odin Writer Guidelines or other project-administration documents.
- Mercor Studio at any point, including the Studio icon, a Studio URL, or any task, instruction or review page.
- Insightful (Workpuls) at any point; it should only run in the background.
- Odin Slack, including the workspace or any Odin Slack URL.

Licensed Content and Copyrights

Any images, videos or other downloaded content which are used for the task must be CC0 or Public Domain. Royalty-free on its own is not enough.

For SWE/ML/DS tasks, public GitHub repositories are fine. Prefer these licenses:

- CC0, PDDL, ODC-by, Apache 2.0, BSD, MIT, Public Domain

Recordings should not contain:

- A visible creator watermark (except Gemini- this watermark is allowed)
- A copyright symbol or ownership notice
- Unverified or unclear licensing
- Paywalled or otherwise restricted material
- Private repositories

❌ Not ok to include
Canva library assets and templates
Pixabay, Pexels, Unsplash, Template.net, and other stock sites
Stock MIDI and video clips
Text compiled from websites
Template backgrounds

LLM Use

- Writers may use Gemini generated content for tasks, but it must be created **before the recording**.
- Writers should not discuss on the recording how the file was generated, or use Gemini to create additional content during recording.
- Writers should also make it clear in their submission how the files were generated if LLM was used.

Detailed LLM use cases

Use Case	Status	Rule
Standard Google Search results	Allowed	Use search results normally
Opening a static link shown in Google AI Overview, including under Show more	Allowed	Do not interact with the AI Overview
Selecting Ask anything in Google AI Overview	Not allowed	This begins an AI interaction
Using AI Mode, Gemini, ChatGPT, Claude, or another conversational assistant	Not allowed	Do not prompt, chat, ask follow-up questions, generate, or summarize
Using AI to generate task content during recording	Not allowed	Task content must be created manually through the recorded professional workflow
Using an AI-powered feature for substantive task work	Not allowed	The feature cannot make meaningful task decisions or create the deliverable
Using ordinary built-in functionality that is not presented as AI	May be allowed	It must involve no prompting, conversation, generation, or summarization
Running software that contains an AI or ML component	Conditionally allowed	It must be part of normal software validation and cannot act as an assistant that completes the task

When an AI feature is built in

There may be cases where part of the workflow has a feature which uses AI/ML to perform part of the task work- for example, Photoshop subject identification may have AI tooling.

How to handle:

- If the feature is not presented as AI, involves no prompting/generative AI, and only performs incidental quality cleanup rather than substantive task work, it may be acceptable.

- For SWE tasks, writers may use code that includes an AI/ML component (such as building foundation models). Running the code may be acceptable only if it is part of normal SWE validation and not being used as an external assistant to complete the task.

App use

Unlisted apps and apps without prior approval are fine unless they are banned or restricted according to the list and rules in the Writer Handbook.

- Insightful (Workpuls) and Splashtop Streamer must stay in the background.
- Every listed app must contribute meaningfully to the deliverable. Copying text from one app into another doesn't count.
- List web apps themselves (e.g., Google Docs), not the browser they run in. List the browser only when it's used as an app in its own right.
- Don't list the notes app used during setup unless it's used in the task.

Deliverables

You should open all of the files for each task and check everything is there and aligns with the task performed in the video recording. Websites visited only for research aren't inputs. Don't fail a task for leaving them out.

Deliverable file type	What it is	Naming convention
Inputs	Any original starting files they prepared in advance.	'input 1', 'input 2', etc.
Intermediate Artifacts	Any files downloaded during recording, intermediate deliverables, or work-in-progress artifacts created during the task.	'artifact 1', 'artifact 2', etc.
Final outputs	The final product they produced.	'final output 1', 'final output 2', etc.

AutoQC coverage (for reference)

AutoQC checks do not replace the current reviewer guidance or manual checklist. A green result is not a band 1 on its own.

Always review the AutoQC, and any disputes, when performing your review.

- **Item 1 (Metadata.rtf Upload):** Checks the file name, template text left in, unnumbered Task Description steps, a Topology step with no LOOKUP/CREATE/MODIFY tag, or a Request under 70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal. It does not compare apps.
- **Item 2:** Checks if a window covers about 25% or more of another for over 30 s. It does not check 6-30 s, or any cover over the window being worked in.
- **Item 3:** AutoQC checks for two of What, Where and Why on actions that change the document. It can pass narration with What and Why but not Where. Check Where coverage yourself.
- **Item 4:** AutoQC checks whether the recording matches the described task. Independently verify that every major action promised in the task appears in the recording.
- **Item 5:** Checks if the menu-bar clock does not show seconds.
- **Item 6:** advice only when no document stating the task is shown at the start.
- **Item 7:** intro length: retained in AutoQC for advisory feedback only. Never blocks approval and is not scored in the reviewer checklist.
- **Item 8:** Checks if there is typing over 25% of the video (35% for Coding and Content & Writing).
- **Item 9:** Checks silence duration: retained in AutoQC for advisory feedback only. Never blocks approval and is not scored in the reviewer checklist.
- **Item 10:** background-noise checks- but these do not replace the first-listen clarity test. Ensure the audio is clear.

AutoQC also checks: That all files uploaded and readable, video length is 15:00-54:59, deliverable file names, final output saved during the recording, Dock visible at start and end, Accessibility Inspector running with its window hidden, TaskRecorder description and Used Apps, at least one UI element changed, mouse idle, banned apps, background-only apps

(Insightful, Splashtop) in front for 10 s or more, limited-use apps over 20% of the video, and work on an unrecorded screen.

Reviewer FAQ

Probation

How do probation audits work, and how many reviews can I complete?

Reviews are audited in pairs. If both reviews in the first pair pass, you pass probation. If either review in the first pair fails, complete a second pair of audited reviews. Both reviews in the second pair must pass; if either fails, you fail probation. You may complete at most four reviews while awaiting audit feedback.

A clean review reaches the correct decision for the right reasons, catches the major issues and gives the writer clear instructions for any required fixes.

Does “Approved (Probation)” mean I am personally on probation?

That task label does not establish your personal reviewer status. Use your assessment outcome and the auditor’s confirmation. The current onboarding guide asks you to allow up to 48 hours before reporting that probation feedback has not arrived; this is a reporting guideline, not a guaranteed turnaround.

My probation audit is delayed.

The target is 48 hours, but audits can take longer. If your audit has been waiting for days or appears not to have reached the queue, tag @Maven in #odin-reviewers-hub with the task links, submission dates and available results. Ask Maven to escalate the delayed or missing audit to an EPM. Keep follow-up in the same thread.

Stay within your approved allowance and the four-review probation limit while awaiting the result. The audit target is not a guaranteed completion time.

What happens if I don't pass probation?

If you don’t pass probation then you will be offered a writer contract to remain on the project.

Are screening scores shared?

Screening scores are not shared in order to keep the answers confidential. You can get feedback from your first few reviews on probation or through reaching out to your review lead / EPM.

Payments

What if I’m missing a payment or my payment is wrong?

Keep your contract, applicable offer, dates, tracked hours and task/review links. For an expected payment or bonus still missing after two pay cycles, use the Pay & Role Request Form with your @mercor.expert account; the stated response time is 2 business days.

To dispute hours that were removed, see Disputes.

Where can I see my pay?

The Odin dashboard's My pay page includes the reviewer quiz bonus and the October 23 payouts, with bonus status and a link to the original announcement. Use your invitation and the applicable offer to confirm eligibility; a dashboard entry does not replace those terms.

The bonus may take up to two days to appear under normal circumstances. Please only submit a dispute form after this window, to give it time to display.

My pay shows hours and base pay recorded for each pay week, or an estimate if processing is incomplete. Bonuses show Paid, Processing or Not yet issued, with the original announcement linked. Processing remains until you receive the payment. Report missing or incorrect amounts through the payment query form above, not Slack comments or DMs.

When will I get paid?

Hourly pay is sent every Wednesday for the previous Saturday–Friday workweek, measured in India time.

Tier bonuses are normally paid the Wednesday after the corresponding hourly payment, although they may arrive earlier or with that payment. A tier bonus is the amount above the base hourly rate in your contract. Separately announced incentives follow their own payout terms.

It may take up to a week after the bonus earning period has **ended** for announced incentives to reflect in your account.

Complete the payout setup instructions provided with your offer. Stripe is the primary payment provider for ongoing contributors. Wise is generally used for one-time payments, contributors who have not completed Stripe onboarding, or bank accounts in countries Stripe does not support.

First-payout verification may add 3–5 business days. Bank holidays, processing schedules and bank cutoffs may also delay settlement.

Queues and claims

Which review queue should I use?

Clear My re-reviews first, then work from the top of the Prioritized Review Queue. If both are empty, you may use the regular Review Queue. Only independent reviewers who are not on probation should take idea reviews; these are found under Needs Review in Full Workflow.

Where is the Claim button?

Open the task and scroll to the bottom of the left-hand panel. Scrolling the middle video panel will not reveal it.

Why can’t I claim this task?

Open the task and check its current status and claim availability. A queue entry does not guarantee that it is still available; another reviewer may have claimed it. Refresh and check your active claims. If the problem persists across eligible tasks, tag @Maven in #odin-reviewers-hub with the task links, statuses and a screenshot, and ask for EPM escalation.

Is 45 minutes a hard limit for each review?

No. It is an average handling-time target. Complete the checks required for the assigned review path and track eligible time actually worked. Claim-extension and release instructions are separate; follow Workflow if you need longer to finish.

Is a re-review reserved for me?

Do not assume that a task you reviewed previously will return to you or be reserved for you. Check My re-reviews and the task’s current claim availability, then follow the published queue priority. A previous review does not guarantee that you can claim the next review.

Can I write tasks when review queues are empty or re-reviews go elsewhere?

Yes, when nothing is available to review, you may create and submit your own tasks without additional permission. A re-review going to someone else does not qualify if other review work is available. Check the queues and prioritize reviewing when work becomes available.

Use the Reviewer timer while reviewing, as required from October 27, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. Pacific. Do not log writing time on the Reviewer timer.

You will be paid $100 + $2/minute for each task you write that reaches RFD.

Current claim timing and Quick Review access

Decisions and feedback

Current checklist and exceptions

Feedback templates

Which Metadata.rtf file should I review?

Review and correct the file in Metadata.rtf Upload. See Reviewer Checklist → Metadata.rtf for the draft/final distinction.

My review matched the final decision. Why did I fail the audit?

Auditors check your reasoning and feedback as well as the final decision. A review can fail if it misses a major issue, bases the decision on incorrect reasoning, or does not tell the writer what to fix. For required fixes, identify the issue, include a timestamp where relevant, and explain the change needed. Minor misses alone do not fail an audit, and extra feedback on nonblocking

issues is allowed. Keep the complete feedback in the writer-facing Studio field so the writer and auditor can review it.

Why are my review fields or decision buttons unavailable?

Check the task, world, current status and whether your claim is still active. Preserve your review notes. Tag @Maven in #odin-reviewers-hub with the exact error, task link and screenshot, and ask for EPM escalation if the problem remains unresolved. An unavailable button alone does not identify the cause.

How do checklist bands differ from Writer Quality Score?

Checklist 1 is ideal, 2 is within tolerance and 3 requires edits unless an explicit exception applies. For a full review, Writer Quality Scores 3–5 are approvable and 1–2 mean edits. A quality score of 3 is therefore different from checklist band 3. On re-review, score the current evidence rather than retaining ratings for corrected issues.

What narration is acceptable?

At least 70% of actions must explain what and where; why is optional for the acceptable band. Assess clarity separately at normal playback. An AutoQC pass can miss missing Where coverage. See Standards for the action definition and full criteria.

Is mouse inactivity a reason to send back?

Mouse inactivity alone is not a scored failure or a reason to reject, send back or require re-recording. Record useful timestamps and context in Internal Notes. The closing epilogue may be still. Separate typing and narration requirements continue to apply.

How much feedback should I write?

Write enough specific, timestamped feedback for the writer to fix every required issue. One or two sentences is not a hard limit. Separate required changes from growth notes. Save the full feedback in the writer-facing Studio field and send the writer a Slack DM. Both are required; keep the outcome, required fixes and timestamps consistent.

Do intro length, silence duration or click pacing require edits?

No, not on their own. These are no longer scored in the reviewer checklist. Intro-length and silence-duration findings remain in AutoQC but never block approval. Keep feedback advisory: the writer targets remain an intro under 20 seconds, silent gaps of 45 seconds or less and deliberate clicks with a pause of about 1 second. Assess narration coverage and first-listen clarity under the remaining checklist items.

Does an epilogue longer than four minutes require edits?

No. An epilogue over 4:00 or lacking detail is band 2 (nonfailing). Give improvement feedback where useful; do not send back or require re-recording for that alone. A missing epilogue uses the unscored “Missing epilogue — does not block approval” response.

Files you cannot open

What if I cannot open a deliverable on my computer?

The files still need to be opened and checked against the recording. Seek help from a reviewer with a compatible setup who can verify that format; do not skip the file check.

Copy/paste

Is copy/paste allowed to reduce typing?

Yes, alongside small typed additions and explanations that demonstrate the writer’s analysis. For example, a pre-made table can be filled in and explained as the problem is solved. Pasting alone should not replace the analysis.

Task statuses

What does RFD mean?

Ready for Delivery: the task has passed every required check and is final for delivery. RFD - Minor is a different status and is not final approval; see the next question.

What do RFD – Minor and "Under Quality Review" mean?

Both are quality re-review statuses for tasks that were sent back: RFD - Minor for minor issues and Under Quality Review for larger ones. Neither is final approval, and neither waives any requirement. The re-review checks every requirement again. If the task passes, it moves to Ready for Delivery; if not, it is sent back for fixes or archived. Mouse-inactivity findings are recorded as delivery callouts, not reasons to send back on their own.

Review limits

What happens to tasks already at or beyond four reviews when the cap takes effect?

The three-review cap takes effect October 29, 2026 at 5:30 p.m. Pacific.

Tasks already at or beyond the cap may receive one final review if the writer submits the final revision by October 30, 2026 11:59 PM PT. A final revision submitted by the cutoff remains eligible for that review even if it is still waiting in the queue after the deadline; approval does not need to happen before the cutoff.

If that final review still requires changes from the writer, reject the task rather than sending it back again.

Account sync or onboarding problems

Can Maven in Slack tell me my Odin role?

No. The Maven that responds in Odin Slack channels does not have live access to Studio and cannot see your Mercor dashboard, so it cannot confirm your current role. Ask an EPM to check your role on Studio.

To see the role you should have, go to work.mercor.com → Home → Contracts and check what it says for Odin.

Check the hour allowance shown in Insightful and ask an EPM to check your role on Studio. Use the Pay & Role Request Form to report discrepancies between your expected role, hour cap or Studio access. Describe your Odin contract, Insightful allowance, the Studio role confirmed by the EPM and any blocked step. Any reported hour-cap discrepancy must also be escalated to an EPM.

My reviewer role, hour cap or access is still wrong.

Follow the checks above: check your Odin contract and Insightful hour allowance, and ask an EPM to check your role on Studio. Use the Pay & Role Request Form to report a discrepancy in your expected role, hour cap or Studio access, and describe what is preventing you from working. Any reported hour-cap discrepancy must also be escalated to an EPM.

Follow your confirmed work permissions and allowance while awaiting an update. Submitting the form does not itself change your role, grant access or increase your hours.

The assessment glitched or the next part is locked. What should I do?

There are no assessment retakes. Complete all parts of your assigned assessment; continuing to the next assigned part is not a retake. A blocked or missing next step does not by itself mean you failed. Reporting a technical issue does not authorize a retake or change your result. The team is looking into these assessment issues and is taking note of the technical issues raised.

What if Insightful is not tracking correctly?

For ordinary hourly work, pause while accurate tracking is broken. Tag @Maven in #odin-reviewers-hub with the exact error, affected time and a redacted screenshot, and ask for EPM escalation if unresolved. A broken timer is different from an exhausted allowance.

Wrong review decision

What if a task received the wrong decision?

If a task received the wrong review decision, post in #odin-reviewers-hub and tag @Maven. Include the task URL, current decision, requested decision and reason. Ask Maven to escalate to an EPM if the decision needs to be corrected.

If the correction requires a send-back, include specific writer-facing feedback and relevant timestamps. If the task is reassigned to you, add that feedback before sending it back. Attach corrected files when requesting a file replacement.

Reviewer setup & access

Where do I start as a new reviewer?

Start with this guide, and complete the reviewer onboarding in the Odin dashboard. Choose the correct route for a new hire or promoted writer. The live onboarding session is optional. Sessions run on weekdays only and alternate between 10:00 am PT and 4:00 am PT. Join from the link for your date:

- Friday, Oct 30 — 10:00 am PT
- Monday, Nov 2 — 4:00 am PT
- Tuesday, Nov 3 — 10:00 am PT
- Wednesday, Nov 4 — 4:00 am PT
- Thursday, Nov 5 — 10:00 am PT
- Friday, Nov 6 — 4:00 am PT
- Monday, Nov 9 — 10:00 am PT
- Tuesday, Nov 10 — 4:00 am PT
- Wednesday, Nov 11 — 10:00 am PT
- Thursday, Nov 12 — 4:00 am PT
- Friday, Nov 13 — 10:00 am PT

What do I need to complete before reviewing?

Complete the required training and all parts of your assigned assessment. Promoted writers with first-pass approvals on four of their last five tasks are exempt from the assessment. The assessment includes two mock reviews and a narration check, assessed together.

Follow your confirmed assessment outcome and work permissions. A role offer, task label or hour balance does not by itself establish that you may review independently.

Do I need a Mac to review tasks?

Reviews run in Studio through your browser on Mac or Windows. Recording tasks requires a physical Mac (Apple silicon or Intel) running macOS 15 or newer. Reviewers may write when no review work is available under the arrangement in Role & Pay; an approved switch to Writer is not required for that arrangement.

I passed the quiz but cannot see the reviewer queue. What should I do?

The team is looking into provisioning issues affecting reviewers who have passed the assessment but cannot yet see the reviewer queue.

Why do the guidelines or onboarding links say “Access denied”?

Open them in a browser signed in to Google with your @mercor.expert account. A personal Google account can trigger organization or permission restrictions.

Can I retake a quiz or see the individual answers?

There are no assessment retakes, and individual answers are not shared.

Are promoted writers exempt from the assessment?

Promoted writers with first-pass approvals on four of their last five tasks are exempt. Being offered a reviewer role alone does not establish that you meet this exemption.

What happens after a final failed assessment?

Stop reviewing. If you want to request a switch to Writer, use the Pay & Role Request Form . Writer work requires confirmation of the role, terms and access, along with a supported Mac.

To leave the project, ask Maven in work.mercor.com > Maven and ask to be offboarded from Odin.

Incorrect caps or access

What should I do when the initial hour cap blocks me?

Check your Odin contract in work.mercor.com → Home → Contracts and the hour allowance shown in Insightful. Report an hour-cap discrepancy using the Pay & Role Request Form and escalate it to an EPM.

Example Tasks

🎯 **After this phase, you will:**

- Understand what a bad task looks like, and why
- Understand what a good task looks like, and why

What makes a good vs. a bad task

✅ Good task	❌ Bad task
Completes the approved goal and workflow, produces the required deliverables and verifies the result. Complexity and professional-level sophistication are not scored.	Has repetitive steps that add nothing to the workflow.
Has no set-up issues (menubar is visible with the seconds, accessibility inspector has a dot underneath it and TaskRecorder is prefilled with the goal and the task apps)	Set-up is incomplete/absent
Task length is within the 15 minute and 54:59 minute threshold	Task length is either lower than the 15 minute threshold or over the 54:59 minute threshold
Does not contain any PII	Contains disallowed identifying information, such as private contact or account details. Apply the privacy guidance's exceptions for names and public information.
App use complies with the current categories, use limits and applicable in-flight protections.	App use violates a current requirement and is not covered by an applicable in-flight protection.
AI is not used during the recording. Inputs may be prepared with AI before recording if that preparation is disclosed.	The writer uses AI during their recording/ interacts with AI prompts such as 'Ask me anything'.
Has all the 4 files including the final file in Metadata.rtf Upload, video.mp4 file, recording_TIMESTAMP.zip and the	Is missing one or all the files required to review the task.

✅ Good task	❌ Bad task
deliverables.zip	
The deliverables.zip contains all the files including the input file, artifacts and final outputs.	The deliverables.zip is missing the final output
Bottom Dock is acceptable when at least one UI element has been changed	Bottom Dock with no UI element changed; the issue is missing UI diversity, not Dock position.
Has at least one UI element, such as the position of the dock, wallpaper, resolution, the mode or the color of the icons.	No UI change apart from the position of the dock.
Working windows remain readable and unnecessary overlaps are minimized.	An unused window covers more than 25% of another for over 30 seconds
The cursor naturally guides the viewer. The closing epilogue may be still.	The cursor sits still for long stretches outside the epilogue (a timestamped callout, not a send-back on its own).
Typing is ≤25% for a non-coding and non-Content & Writing task and ≤35% for a Coding / Content & Writing task	Typing is >25% for a non-coding and non-Content & Writing task and >35% for a Coding / Content & Writing task
At least 70% of actions say what is done and where it is on screen; why is added when useful. Narration can be followed on first listen. Silence duration is advisory and never blocks approval.	Fewer than 70% of actions explain what is done and where it is on screen. Vague words such as ‘this’ and ‘here’ do not identify the element or its location.
Mercor Studio and Insightful stay off screen. Mentions of Mercor or Project Odin are fine.	Mercor Studio or Insightful is visible on screen.

❌Bad Example❌

Use the Bad Example to study Project Odin quality guideline violations.

1. Data Science and Analytics

Task Description

> As a data scientist who is compiling information to help guide decision making for the upcoming state election in Victoria, I have been tasked with presenting specific demographic data to decision makers. As part of this I need to prefer data for age

demographics for a regional town area (Ararat, VIC) against overall state averages to be used in a future presentation.

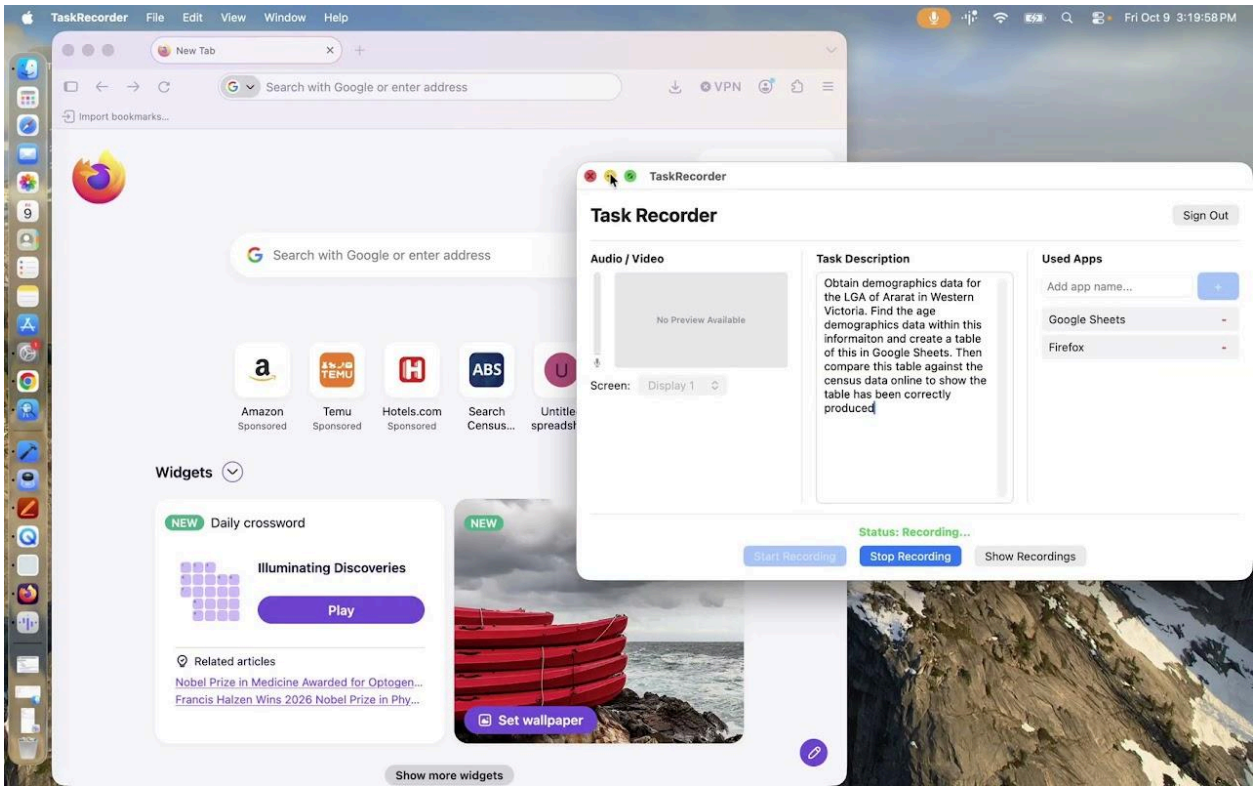
I will use Firefox to obtain the data for the publicly available census 2026 data that can be commercial planning, market research, and strategy and download as a CSV file. I will then load the data into Google Sheets to analyse the data and create a plot of the data in a comparison format between the community and state. I will then print the data to pdf to be used as required, and open it in preview to show that the print worked.

Apps Used

Firefox

Google Sheets

Video: Full task recording (16:41)



Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance
1. Metadata.rtf matches the TaskRecorder Goal (apps, workflow)	Yes		

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance
2. No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s	Not scored in this example		
3. Narration says what and where for each action, and why when useful	Not scored in this example		
4. Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task	Not scored in this example		
5. The menu bar clock shows seconds at the start and end of the video	Yes		
6. The Goal document is shown at the start of the recording			No
7. Typing takes up 25% of the video or less (35% for Coding / Content & Writing)	Yes, about 20% of the task		
8. The narration can be understood on first listen	Yes, no background noise		
9. The recording is free of disallowed AI use	Yes		
10. The recording is free of PII, on screen and in the audio	Yes		
11. Deliverable assets meet licensing requirements	Yes		

Checklist item	1 = Ideal state	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Failing tolerance
12. The narration and everything on screen are free of profanity	Yes		
13. Narration and deliverables are in English; minor non-English content on screen is acceptable	Yes		
14. Epilogue narration (over 4:00 is nonfailing)	Not scored in this example		

Verdict: send back. Item 6 (Goal document not shown) is at band 3. Click pacing is no longer scored and does not support this send-back. The original example also recorded app-use and submission-confirmation concerns. Assess app-use concerns under the current rules and applicable in-flight protections; an old restricted label alone does not establish a failure. “Not scored in this example” means the original example did not record a score for that item.

🏅 Golden Examples 🏅

Use the Golden Examples to study professional workflow and narration standards.

- Finance
- Design
- Audio & Music
- Animation & VFX
- Software & AI/ML Engineering

1. Finance

Task Description

I am an Account Receivable personnel at a company in the UK and have been tasked with adding a new vendor to our ERP system and creating a Purchase Order (PO) tracking workflow for our Accounting team to manage POs better. I will begin by adding missing information onto a sample PO on the Pages app, then transfer the vendor details, and PO line items onto our ERP system on Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central, and finally create a PO tracking workflow on Monday.com. I will verify the flow is complete by running the same at the end of its creation and check if the status updates as per the trigger, and deliver the final PO raised on Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central and the PO workflow from Monday.com to my team.

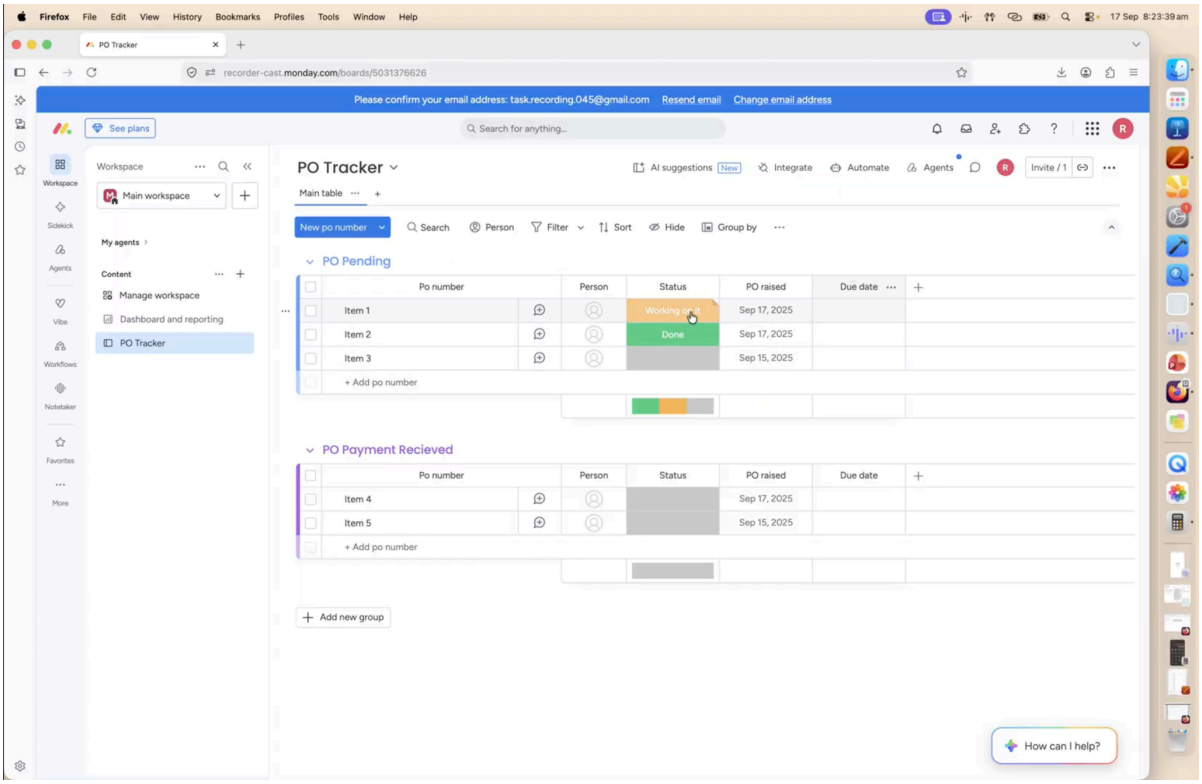
Apps Used

Monday.com

Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central

Pages

Video: Full task recording (44:19)



2. Design

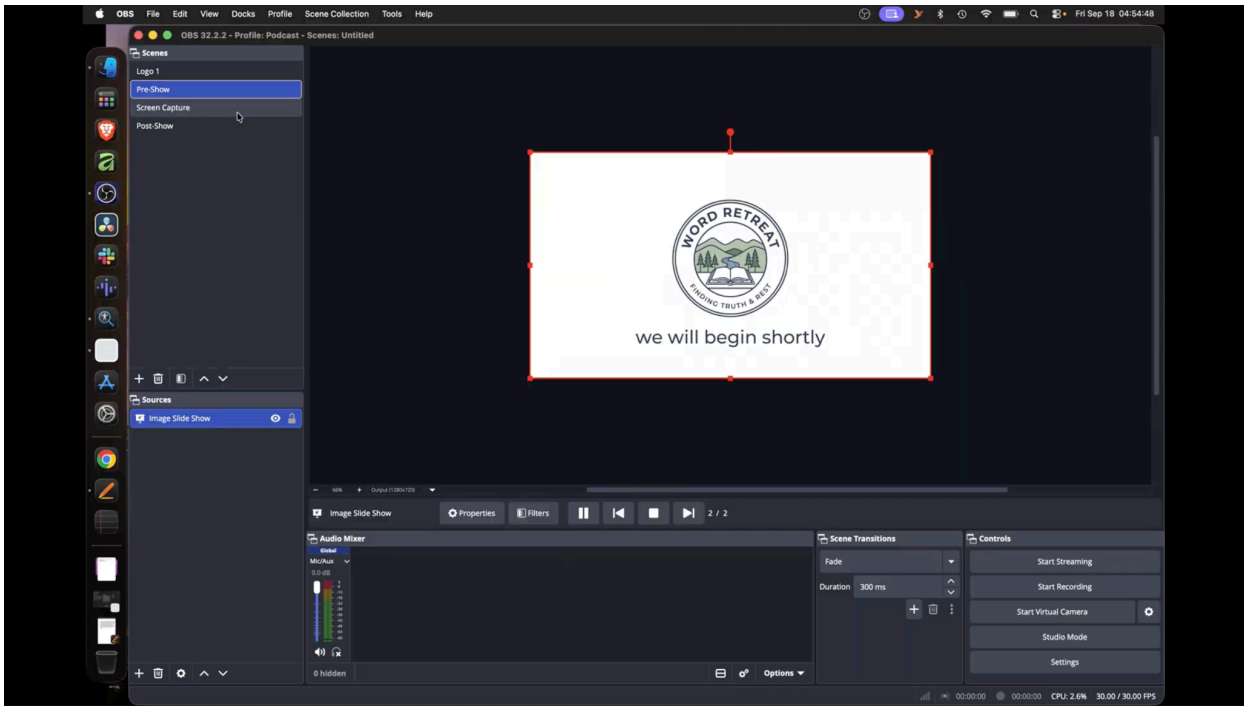
Task Description

I am a Content Creator preparing aspects of a new podcast. Using OBS Studio, I will setup different scenes for different aspects of the podcast such as pre-show and screen-share, which will involve the import of some images. The final deliverables will be the export of the scenes created in OBS.

Apps Used

OBS Studio

Video: Full task recording (24:44)



3. Audio & Music

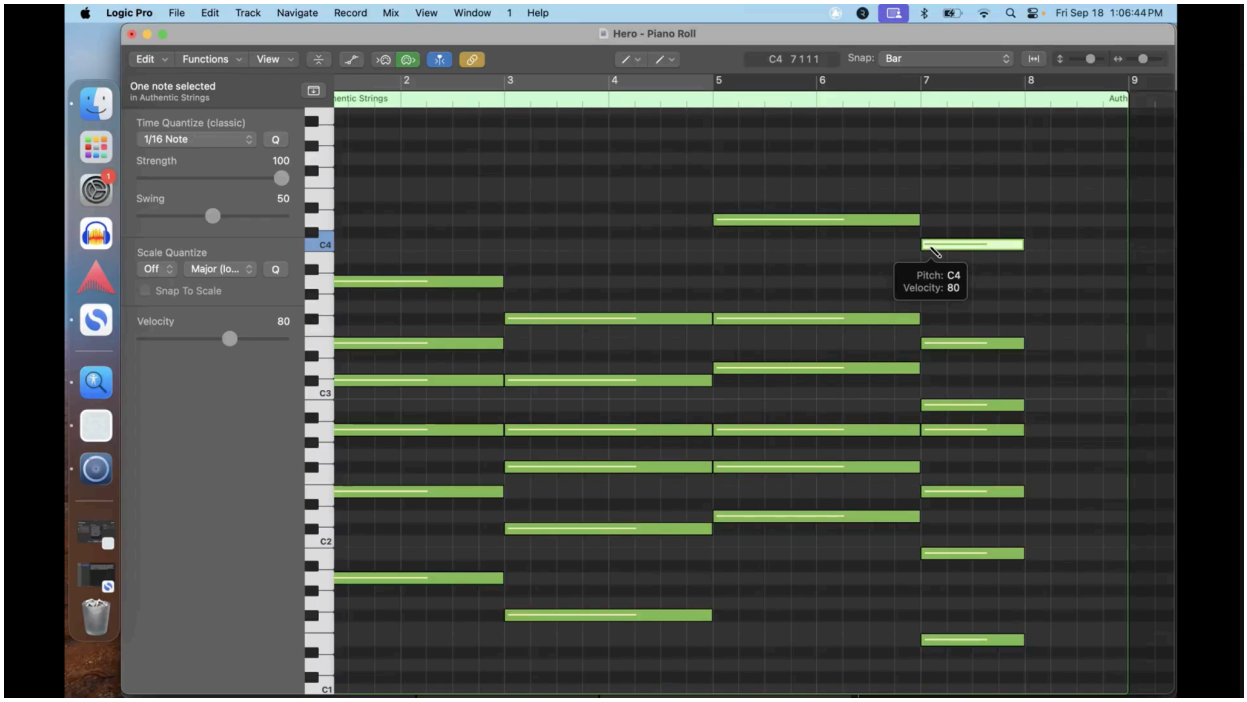
Task Description

I am a film score composer and I'm working on the underlying theme for a heroic end credit sequence. I will use Logic Pro in the second phase (P2) of the execution to compose a string accompaniment for the piano top melody created in phase one (PI). I will also establish a chordal sequence (I - vi - IV - V) to define the passage. The final deliverable will be a stereo export of the complete Logic Pro session.

Apps Used

Logic Pro

Video: Full task recording (22:58)



4. Animation & VFX

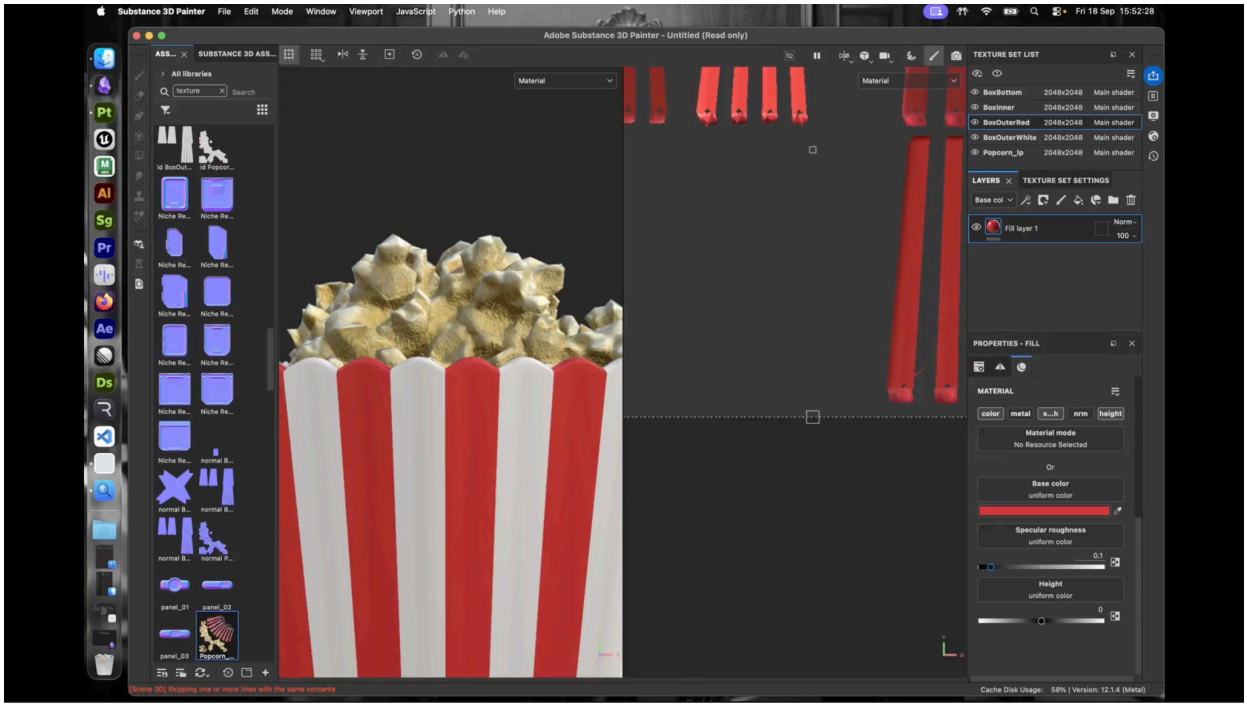
Task Description

You are a 3D Modeler tasked with cleaning up the textures of a photogrammetry model for use in Unreal Engine. Use Adobe Substance 3D Painter to bake the provided high poly model onto the provided low poly model, apply the provided photogrammetry diffuse texture, clean up artifacts on the texture, add a powdery finish to the popcorn and add red and white striped packaging textures to the popcorn box. Export the texture maps appropriate for use in Unreal Engine.

Apps Used

Substance 3D Painter

Video: Full task recording (40:59)



5. Software & AI/ML Engineering

Task Description

As an iOS app developer I want to create a distinctive visual identity for a simple Music Player app. Use SF Symbols as independent visual components, and compose them as separate layers in Icon Composer. Build & refine the multi-layered icon in Icon Composer and integrate the resulting icon into a SwiftUI Music Player app in Xcode. Deliver the layered icon and Xcode project; verify that the app builds successfully and the icon is correctly integrated.

Apps Used

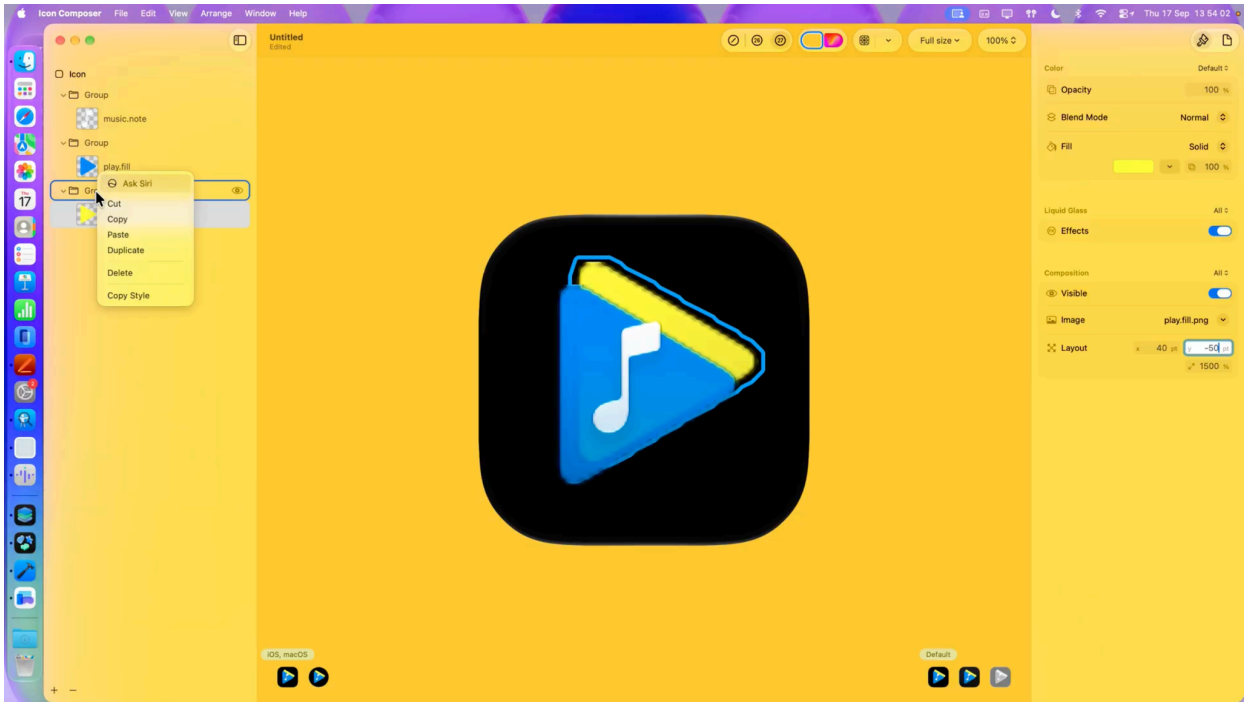
Device Hub

Xcode

SF Symbols

Icon Composer

Video: Full task recording (28:37)


Icon Composer
File
Edit
View
Arrange
Window
Help
Thu 17 Sep 13 54 02
Untitled
Edited
Full size
100%
Icon
Group
music.note
Group
play.fill
Ask Siri
Cut
Copy
Paste
Duplicate
Delete
Copy Style
Color
Default
Opacity
100 %
Blend Mode
Normal
Fill
Solid
100 %
Liquid Glass
All
Effects
Composition
All
Visible
Image
play.fill.png
Layout
40 pt
-50 pt
1500 %
iOS, macOS
Default

Feedback Templates

🎯 **After this phase, you will:**

- Have a catalogue of templates to use to help communicate with writers!

Templates

In the following tabs, you will find templates for DM communication with writers. Here's a list of what you will find.

General Feedback

- Detailed templates for general writer feedback

Setup and TaskRecorder

- Metadata.rtf corrected by reviewer
- Menu bar clock shows seconds
- Dock visibility at start and end: advisory feedback, not a standalone failure
- Bottom Dock is nonblocking with at least 1 UI change
- Accessibility Inspector running (dot under Dock icon)
- Accessibility Inspector window hidden
- TaskRecorder window minimized: advisory feedback, not a standalone failure
- TaskRecorder description and apps: file fix; preserve original and corrected descriptions in Internal Notes, no rerecord for this alone
- Task description document shown at start
- Intro length: advisory feedback only; never blocks approval
- At least 1 UI element changed
- English narration and deliverables; minor non-English content on screen is acceptable

Content and compliance

- Free of disallowed AI use: ordinary incidental enhancement may be acceptable; substantive AI task tools are not automatically allowed. Follow the detailed AI guidance and escalate unclear cases.
- Free of PII (screen and audio)
- Project references alone are allowed; Mercor Studio, Insightful and Odin Slack on screen require edits. Assess personal information separately.
- Deliverable assets meet licensing requirements: apply documented exceptions
- Profanity: apply the minor on-screen exception; assess explicit content separately
- Current banned-app, limited-use and app-specific rules followed

- Task complexity and professional-level sophistication are not scored
- Task checklist and PII confirmation completed truthfully

Performance

- Narration must be understandable on first listen; speed alone has no words-per-minute failure threshold
- Silence duration: advisory feedback only; never blocks approval
- Narration audio clear (loud typing OK if narration stays clear)
- Typing 25% or less (35% or less for Coding / Content & Writing); equality does not fail
- Click pacing: advisory feedback only; not scored

AutoQC

- Disputes (agree)
- Disputes (disagree)
- Not run

Files

- All four task files uploaded
- Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present
- video.mp4 opens
- Deliverables named correctly
- Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, request, workflow)

Recording

- Video: writer target 15:00-50:59; reviewer acceptance 15:00-54:59
- Keep the content being worked on visible; minor overlap alone is not an error
- Mouse inactivity: qualitative delivery callouts only, not graded; the closing epilogue may be still
- Narration: What and Where, with Why where useful
- Recording shows the writer doing what the task description says

Odin Reviewer Feedback Templates

Header line for every review:

MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME

Writing rules for every snippet:

- Give a timestamp (MM:SS) for anything seen in the video.
- Say what was wrong, why the client needs it, and what to do next time.
- Use the current status names: Needs Edits and Rejected (not "Needs Revision").
- Point to the Writer Guidelines section by name when it helps.

Approved (all items at 1)

Use when every current manual item and AutoQC requirement passes. Delete any line that does not apply to this task.

MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME

Comments: Task approved. Clear narration identifies the action, specific element and screen location, with Why where useful. Setup, Goal document, Metadata.rtf Upload, app-use rules, privacy, licensing, profanity, English, window management and typing checked against the applicable checklist. Video length, screenshot count, original recording ZIP, video.mp4 and deliverables.zip verified. The task is complete with its required final deliverable. Reviewer: delete any statement you did not verify; use only the checks required for the review path.

Approved with growth notes (no blocking failure)

Use when the task passes, but one or more items are within tolerance. Paste the matching snippets under Areas to grow. Do not include band numbers in writer-facing feedback.

MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME

Hi ___,

I've approved task ___. You did a strong job on ___.

Areas to grow for your next tasks:

- [paste snippet]

- [paste snippet]

None of these blocked approval this time, but items at the edge of tolerance can fail on a future task. The Workflow Checklist in the Writer Guidelines covers each one. Keep up the great work!

Needs Edits (a current blocking item fails)

Use when at least one current blocking item fails but can be fixed within the approved idea. Split required writer fixes into recording and file fixes. Reviewers correct and verify the file in

Metadata.rtf Upload themselves; a fixable metadata issue alone does not require a writer send-back or rerecord.

MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME

Hi ___,

I've completed my review of task ___. You did a good job on ___, but the items below need to be fixed before I can approve it.

Requires a re-record:

- [paste snippet]

File fixes (the reviewer handles fixable Metadata.rtf errors):

- [paste snippet]

Growth notes (did not block approval):

- [paste snippet]

Please run full AutoQC again after changes before resubmitting, and use the Workflow Checklist in the Writer Handbook. Address every required fix together. Approval depends on the completed review; the next submission is not guaranteed approval. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Rejected (Invalid Task Idea)

Rejected is for a task whose concept cannot be fixed within the approved scope. A correctable app-use violation, a recording that does not match the approved workflow, or several failures together does not automatically make the task Rejected. If the task can be corrected within the approved idea, use Needs Edits. If you are unsure whether the task description is valid, explain the issue in writer-facing Studio feedback and Send for Edits instead. Apply the separate review-attempt cap and transition policy. Pick only a reason that makes the task concept unfixable and delete the others.

MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME

Hi ___,

I've completed my review of task ___. Unfortunately, this task cannot be approved or fixed through edits, for the reason below. Please do not resubmit this rejected task.

- Unfixable app-policy conflict: The approved task cannot be completed without ___, which is prohibited by the current app policy: ___. Check the canonical app list, app-specific conditions and in-flight protections. If the violation can be corrected within the approved idea, use Needs Edits instead. Unlisted apps and missing prior app approval do not fail by themselves.

- Task concept: The approved workflow doesn't seem like it can be completed without [excessive typing /exceeding the allotted timeframe], so no re-record of this idea would meet the requirements.

- Do not select task complexity or lack of professional-level sophistication as a rejection reason. These restrictions are retired; assess whether the approved task and its required deliverables are complete.

- Unfixable task concept: ___ cannot be corrected within the approved idea because ___. A recording that differs from the approved idea is not, by itself, an unfixable concept; use Needs Edits when a compliant recording of the approved workflow is possible.

For your next task, propose an idea in Studio and follow the current Task Ideation and app-use guidance in the Writer Guidelines. For a brief video with further details, see here. I look forward to your next submission.

Setup and TaskRecorder

Metadata.rtf corrected by reviewer:

file fix; do not send back for metadata alone

Metadata.rtf - I corrected Metadata.rtf to match the actual task and verified the corrected file in Metadata.rtf Upload. No writer action is needed for this metadata correction. Reviewer: use this message only after making and verifying the correction. Preserve the original recording ZIP; retain both the original and corrected task descriptions in Internal Notes. Replace the file in Metadata.rtf Upload. Do not send back or require a rerecord for fixable metadata alone. Every delivery uses a new folder; do not add files to an already-delivered folder.

Menu bar clock shows seconds

Clock seconds - The menu bar clock does not show seconds at [the start / the end] of the recording. Go to System Settings > Menu Bar > Clock Options and turn on "Display the time with seconds," then re-record. For a brief video with further details, see here. Reviewer: check the first and last few seconds; visibility between those points is not required.

Dock visibility at start and end: advisory feedback, not a standalone failure

Dock visibility - For future recordings, keep the Dock visible at the beginning and end. Reviewer: this retired checklist item is advisory only; missing Dock visibility alone is not a send-back reason. Assess required recording data separately.

Dock position and UI diversity

Dock position - A bottom Dock alone must not trigger a send-back when at least one UI element has been changed. **Do not request re-recording solely to move the Dock in that case.**

Accessibility Inspector running (dot under Dock icon)

Accessibility Inspector - Accessibility Inspector wasn't running during the recording (no dot under its Dock icon). TaskRecorder needs it running for the whole recording to capture the required data. Open it from Xcode > Open Developer Tool, close only its window with the red button, and confirm the dot stays under its icon. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Accessibility Inspector window hidden

Accessibility Inspector window - The Accessibility Inspector window was visible at MM:SS. Close its window with the red button before recording (don't minimize or quit the app) so it keeps running in the background. For a brief video with further details, see here.

TaskRecorder window minimized: advisory feedback, not a standalone failure

TaskRecorder window - For future recordings, minimize the TaskRecorder window after starting and reopen it when ready to stop. Reviewer: this retired checklist item is advisory only; the window appearing during the task does not fail the task on its own. Assess any separate current checklist issue under its own rule.

TaskRecorder description and apps: file fix; preserve original and corrected descriptions in Internal Notes, no rerecord for this alone

TaskRecorder fields - The TaskRecorder Task Description/Used Apps did not match the recording: ___. Reviewer: retain both the original and corrected descriptions in Internal Notes, correct Metadata.rtf and any editable Studio fields to match the actual recording and deliverables, and replace and verify the corrected file in Metadata.rtf Upload. Preserve the original recording ZIP. This mismatch alone does not require a rerecord. For future recordings, check the Goal and app list before clicking Start Recording. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Task description document shown at start

Opening Task Description Document - The Goal document wasn't shown at the start of the recording. After starting, minimize TaskRecorder so the Goal document is visible, say the intro sentence, then minimize the document. Use Word, Google Docs or another allowed app (not Notes or TextEdit), and show only the Goal, not the Approval ID. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Intro length: advisory feedback only; never blocks approval

Intro length - Your intro ran about __ seconds. For future tasks, say only “I will be beginning my task soon. Here is the workflow I have in mind,” minimize the Goal document, and begin. Aim for under 20 seconds. Reviewer note: this is advisory feedback only. Intro duration never blocks approval or requires a rerecord on its own, including when AutoQC flags it.

At least 1 UI element changed

UI diversity - The desktop uses the default Mac setup. Please change at least one UI element before recording, such as the wallpaper, light/dark mode, Dock size or resolution, and enter it in Studio's Machine and Display fields. For a brief video with further details, see here.

English narration and deliverables; minor non-English content on screen is acceptable

Language - At MM:SS, [the narration was not fully in English / the deliverable ___ was not in English / there was more than a minor amount of non-English content on screen]. Keep narration fully in English and deliverables in English. Reviewer: minor amounts of non-English content on screen are acceptable; do not request edits for that alone.

Content and compliance

Free of disallowed AI use: ordinary incidental enhancement may be acceptable; substantive AI task tools are not automatically allowed. Follow the detailed AI guidance and escalate unclear cases.

AI use - [Tool/feature] was used to [prompt / generate / summarize] at MM:SS. No AI interaction is allowed during recording, including Google AI Overview's "Ask anything" and AI Mode. Inputs may be prepared with Gemini before recording, with "AI-generated before recording" selected in Studio.

Free of PII (screen and audio)

PII - ___ was [shown on screen / said aloud] at MM:SS. Please re-record without private personally identifiable information, including names, emails, phone numbers, addresses, account details, biometrics and MAC addresses. TaskRecorder 2.4.4 requires no sign-in. For task-app logins, use your mercor.expert account or a new anonymized account as the current app guidance requires. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Project screens: Mercor Studio, Insightful or Odin Slack

Project screens - [Mercor Studio / Insightful / Odin Slack] was visible at MM:SS. Please re-record without it and close or hide project materials before recording. A separate Recorder macOS profile is optional. Reviewer: Mercor/Odin mentions alone are allowed; assess actual PII under the detailed privacy guidance.

Deliverable assets meet licensing requirements: apply documented exceptions

Copyright - ___ included in deliverables.zip at MM:SS does not meet the applicable licensing requirement: ___. Apply the asset-licensing requirement to material included in deliverables.zip. Browsing a website with a trademarked logo is acceptable. Apply the public-repository licensing exceptions in the PII and Copyright Issues guidance. For assets subject to the CC0/public-domain rule, verify the source terms; a search filter alone is not enough. Gemini-generated inputs prepared before recording are allowed. Escalate unclear licensing before deciding. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Profanity: apply the minor on-screen exception; assess explicit content separately

Profanity - Minor on-screen profanity not typed by the writer is within tolerance. Profanity said or typed by the writer, or more than minor on-screen profanity, fails. For a failure: [Profanity was said / profanity was typed / more than minor on-screen profanity was shown] at MM:SS; please re-record without it. Assess explicit content separately: if explicit content was shown at MM:SS, re-record without it.

Current banned-app, limited-use and app-specific rules followed

App-policy issue - ___ was used at MM:SS in a way prohibited by the current banned-app, limited-use or app-specific guidance: ___. Check the canonical app list and in-flight protections. Unlisted apps and missing prior app approval do not fail by themselves. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Task complexity and professional-level sophistication are not scored

Reviewer note - Do not request more complex work or reject a task for lacking professional-level sophistication. Those restrictions are retired. Assess whether the recording completes the approved task and required deliverables.

Task checklist and PII confirmation completed truthfully

Submission checklist - The checklist/PII confirmation was marked complete, but ___ (MM:SS) does not meet that item. Please open the checklist and PII guidelines and verify each item against your recording before checking the box. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Performance

Narration understood on first listen

Growth note: clear but rushed narration

Narration clarity - At MM:SS, ___. Keep your narration clear enough that the listener can follow the action on first listen. For a brief video with further details, see here. Reviewer: pace alone is not a failure; assess whether noise, mumbling, pace or unclear speech prevents understanding.

Failure: narration cannot be understood on first listen

Narration clarity - At MM:SS, [noise / mumbling / pace / unclear speech] makes the action difficult to understand without replaying or guessing. Please re-record so the narration clearly explains the action and its location. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Loud typing is fine if narration remains clear. Do not apply a words-per-minute cutoff.

Silence duration: advisory feedback only; never blocks approval

Growth note only — do not score silence duration or require a rerecord for it.

Narration gap - There was a __-second silent gap at MM:SS. For future tasks, keep narrating while you work, even during typing or repeated steps, so no gap goes over 45 seconds.

Audio clarity

Use the first-listen clarity check

Audio quality - Background noise obscured the narration at MM:SS. For future tasks, record in a quieter space or use headphones with a dedicated microphone. For a brief video with further details, see here. Reviewer: use a growth note only if the video remains understandable on first listen.

Failure: unclear narration

Audio quality - Background noise made the narration unclear at MM:SS. Please re-record in a quieter space or use headphones with a dedicated microphone. Check the microphone level in TaskRecorder first, and do not switch audio devices during recording. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Typing 25% or less (35% or less for Coding / Content & Writing); equality does not fail

Typing - Typing took up about __% of your __-minute recording, over the limit of 25% (35% for Coding / Content & Writing). Exactly 25% or 35%, respectively, does not fail this item. Please re-record with a mouse-driven workflow that meets the total-typing limit. For future recordings, aim to keep each continuous typing segment to 45 seconds or less; exceeding that target alone is not a reviewer failure. If the idea cannot be completed within the total-typing limit, revise the task idea.

Click pacing: advisory feedback only; not scored

Growth note: occasional rushed clicks

Click pacing - A few clicks were rushed (MM:SS, MM:SS). For future tasks, pause about one second after each click so the result is captured.

Growth note: repeated rushed clicks

Click pacing - Clicks lacked a pause in several places (MM:SS, MM:SS, MM:SS). For future tasks, click, wait about a second, then continue. Missing click pauses alone do not justify send-back.

Growth note: rushed clicks throughout; not a standalone failure

Click pacing - Clicks lacked a pause throughout the recording (for example, MM:SS and MM:SS). For future tasks, pause about one second after each click so the result is captured. Missing click pauses alone do not justify send-back.

AutoQC snippets

AutoQC ratings are separate from the three-band manual checklist. Ratings 1 and 2 need no snippet, though a short line for 2 shows the writer their dispute was read. For current blocking checks, ratings 3 (disputed, I disagree) and 4 (failed / not run) use the fail snippet; for a 3, start with the dispute line. Verify the evidence and the current rule. Intro-length and silence-duration AutoQC findings are always advisory and never block approval, regardless of the displayed rating; do not use a fail or rerecord snippet for those findings. Mouse inactivity is a timestamped delivery callout in Internal Notes, not a manual band. Window management follows the current manual checklist. Apply the total-typing limits. A continuous typing segment over the 45-second writer target does not fail by itself.

Dispute lines:

AutoQC dispute (agreed) - I reviewed your dispute on the ___ check and agree with you; it did not count against this task.

AutoQC dispute (not agreed) - I reviewed your dispute on the ___ check but confirmed the issue at MM:SS, so it still needs to be fixed:

Not run:

AutoQC not run - The ___ AutoQC wasn't run before submission. Please run both AutoQCs (Files & Recording and Narration) and resolve any blocking findings before resubmitting. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Files and deliverables

(file fixes unless the recording itself is bad)

All four task files uploaded

Missing files - ___ is missing from Studio. Each task needs four uploads: video.mp4, deliverables.zip, the TaskRecorder recording_TIMESTAMP.zip, and the final Metadata.rtf in Metadata.rtf Upload (not inside deliverables.zip). For a brief video with further details, see here.

Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present

Recording archive - The TaskRecorder zip is [missing files / has only __ screenshots for a __-second video, below 0.5 per second]. This data is required by the client, so the task needs to be re-recorded. Before your next recording, quit unused apps and large browser tabs, keep enough free storage, and run a short test. Don't rename, unzip or edit the original archive. For a brief video with further details, see here.

video.mp4 opens

Video file - video.mp4 [won't open / ends early at MM:SS / is corrupted]. Please check the beginning, middle and end in QuickTime before uploading. If the file is corrupted, the task needs to be re-recorded. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Deliverables named correctly

Deliverable naming - Please name the zip "deliverables.zip" and label files inside it as input 1, artifact 1, final output 1, etc., keeping the correct extensions. Every input, intermediate artifact and final output needs to be in the zip. For a brief video with further details, see here.

Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, request, workflow)

Metadata.rtf - The [Topology / Request / Task Description] section does not match the recording: ___. For a brief video with further details, see here. Reviewer: retain the original and corrected task descriptions in Internal Notes, correct Metadata.rtf to accurately describe the recording and deliverables, and replace and verify the corrected file in Metadata.rtf Upload. Topology should list each app visit in order as LOOKUP, CREATE or MODIFY. Preserve the original recording ZIP. Fixable metadata alone does not require a send-back or rerecord. Every delivery uses a new folder; do not add to an already-delivered folder.

Recording

Video: writer target 15:00-50:59; reviewer acceptance 15:00-54:59

Video length - Your video is __:__ long, outside the reviewer acceptance range of 15:00-54:59 including the intro and epilogue. Please adjust the workflow duration and re-record, planning for the writer target of 15:00-50:59. Do not request a re-record solely because a video exceeds 50:59 but is no longer than 54:59.

Keep the content being worked on visible; minor overlap alone is not an error

Window management - [App 1] obscured the content being worked on in [App 2] at MM:SS. Minor window overlap alone is not an error and does not require edits or a re-record. Please use one Fill window or place task windows side by side, and minimize windows you aren't using. Avoid Full Screen and small floating windows. Pop-ups within the same app are fine while in use.

Mouse inactivity: qualitative delivery callouts only, not graded; the closing epilogue may be still

Delivery callout: the cursor was inactive at MM:SS. Describe the observed duration and context without assigning a grade. Use the cursor naturally as a teaching pointer, without artificial movement. The closing epilogue may be still; an epilogue over 4:00 is nonfailing. The separate typing requirements still apply.

Narration: What and Where, with Why where useful

Narration - The narration needs to be clear enough that a listener could follow the task without seeing the screen. At MM:SS, MM:SS and MM:SS, ___. Name the action, specific element and screen location; avoid vague words like “here” and “this.” Add Why for important or non-obvious decisions. Reviewer: apply the current checklist for narration coverage and clarity. Silence duration never blocks approval; do not put bands or tolerance thresholds in the writer’s message. For a brief video with further details, see here, and for golden examples, see here.

Recording shows the writer doing what the task description says

Workflow match - The recording doesn't complete the approved Goal: ___ [was skipped / was replaced with ___] at MM:SS. Please record the workflow as approved. If your plan changes materially, submit a change request in Studio before recording. For a brief video with further details, see here.